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MALTESE ETYMOLOGICAL GLOSSARY

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The Arabic political domination in Malta lasted from 870 to 1090; but the linguistic influence of the Arabs was prolonged for almost another 200 years, till about 1245 when they were expelled from the island lock, stock and barrel by Frederick II of Sicily. After this expulsion, Arabic linguistic influence in Malta dwindled away till it disappeared completely under the ever-increasing impact of Romance loan-words and loan-formations from Sicily and Southern Italy, especially from the Calabrian area. Much of the Arabic spoken in Malta survived in a crystallized form, in some respects morphologically and semantically closer to classical Arabic than the other Arabic dialects, escaping those cumulative changes which affected the structure of words current in North Africa, not to mention the number of idiomatic phrases many of which are structurally Sicilian or Italian *calques* surviving side by side with genuine Arabic idioms. This glossary is a collection of words of Arabic origin with a few Romance loan-words which are not etymologically straightforward in the sense that they are not etymologically identifiable at first sight as is the case of a large number of words that are obviously common to both Maltese and Arabic.

The list which was collected some years ago and should have seen the light of day about the time my books *Papers in Maltese Linguistics* (1961) and *The Structure of Maltese* (1959) were published, is by no means an exhaustive list of such words. There are many others the origin of which is not immediately identifiable. The origin of those words not included will eventually be traced tentatively or definitively, in the Maltese-English dictionary on which I am working at the moment. It is possible that some of the origins indicated by me are not tenable; even so, they can only be rejected when and if a more likely and acceptable origin is indicated.

The process of tracing words to their immediate or mediate origin is a fruitful exercise in the historical reconstruction of the form of language once spoken in the Maltese islands as it has come down to us in its present form. There is many a hard crust on the surface of some words which takes some time to disappear completely. This is precisely the challenge of documentary etymology.

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Abba tr. v. To love (baby word). Dess. does not give this word. According to Barb. "abba" is the M. version of Sic. *papa* (father), a word by which the father invites his child to kiss him, and according to Vass. "videtur oriri ex. Chald. & Hebr." Car. links it up with Heb. אָבָה. But *abba* is a child's modification of M. *ḥabb*, corresponding to Ar. حَبَّ to love, and in Egyptian Ar. (Hava) and M. also to kiss, in the latter sense when speaking affectionately to children. The disappearance of *ḥ* is explainable as the result of the phonetic difficulty that children, still assimilating the language, must experience in pronouncing this sound, and the vocalic sequence *a-a* may be explained by their fondness for repetition. For similar examples in other languages, see Jesperson's LANGUAGE, Allen & Union p. 109. Car. gives these examples *ejja nabbak*, 'let me kiss you'; *abba l-vava*, 'kiss the baby'. I have heard mothers say to their babies *ḥobbni* or *ḥabbni waḥda, ḥanini*, give me a kiss, my dear' which helps to show that M. *abba* is only a variant of *ḥabb*.

Aḥ m. n. Brother. This form, given in the M. dictionaries, does not occur in the spoken language. M. has *aḥwa*, brothers, pl. pattern *ḥut* when used with pronominal suffixes or in the construct state, and for corresponding sing. it has *ḥu* + pronominal suffixes. Cp. the following note from Març p. 287. "*ḥā* خَا frère: est employé uniquement avec les affixes personnels... l'idée du 'frère' en soi reste à peu près inexprimable... Le pluriel à Tanger est *ḥut*, avec la série des pronoms affixes *ḥuti*, *ḥutek, ḥuto*, etc. *ḥut* a visiblement été tiré des représentants dialectaux de إخوة munis des affixes personnels". The dialect of Tangier and M. agree in this respect.

Ajl, pl. **Ajul**. Porcupine. This word is given by Car. only. Dess. sees no connection with Ar. عَايِل, a small, mean thing, or غَايِل, a stout youth. As the name of an animal it occurs in Heb. אַיִל, 'ram' (Gen. 22. 13) Cp. also Ar. أَلَّ 'to strike with a spear ' (Hava) which may have had a semantic connection with the idea of a quadruped whose body and tail are covered with erectile spines. Names of animals when transferred from a language into another often apply to animals other than those indicated in the original language. Cp. M. *fenek*, 'rabbit'; M. *ziemel*, 'horse'; M. *debba*, 'mare', with their Arabic forms. Cp. also Ass. *ajlu*, Phoen. אילל.

Alla m.n. God. What is interesting in connection with this word is that Vel. writes *allah* for 'God' whence *allahi* for 'divine', and *allahia* for 'divinity'. These forms, which are not given by Vass. who writes *alli* and *allia* with pl. *allin* or *allijin*, 'divine', are made up by etymological analogy. M. phonetics do not tolerate *h* (ه) in an intervocalic position in a final syllable. Barb. gives these forms on the authority of the Maltese Jesuit author Magri (1851-1907). But Magri must have copied them from Vel. or made them up himself by etymological analogy. For the adj. 'divine', Maltese has *t'Alla* (literally, of God) as *imħabba t'Alla*, divine love; *ħwejjeġ t'Alla*, divine mysteries, God's plans; and for Ar. أُلُوهِيَّة , divinity, it has the R. word *divinità*. Also Vass.'s patterns *alli, allia*, etc., (given also by De Soldanis) that are the nearest one could get by formal analogy, must have been made up by him. The abstract vocabulary of Theology, like the Faith of Malta, is mainly Roman.

Allaw pl. Imperative form. "Ite cite, properate, celeriter agite" (Vass.). This word is not reproduced by Falz. but it is given by Car. under *Alla*, 'God', grouped with *Alla* and *jalla* in the sense given by Vass. I do not think the three words should be grouped together. While the first two stand for *Alla* (God invoked to inspire courage, etc.) and *jalla* stands for *ja* (O!) + *Alla* (God), *allaw* is more likely a variation of *talaw* (q. v.) 'Come on!' with initial *t* left out and emphatic reduplication of the medial radical. The imperative pattern *allaw* is not Semitic. It occurs in R. loan-verbs; cf. *żarmaw* pl. imper. from *żarma*, to disarm; *iffrankaw*, from *iffranka*, to save. The pl. imperative of hypothetic *alla* would be *allu*, not *allaw*. Cf. *qallu* from *qalla*, to fry; *għallu*, from *għalla*, to boil.

Amar, tr. v. To command, with the following words as its derivatives: *amar*, v. n. a command; *amir*, m. n. commander; and pp. *mamur*, comaned. Of these *amir* as in Car. or *emir* as in Vass. and Falz. survives in the old saying, *Li jiena kont amir u int amir, kieku min isuq il-ħmir?* If I had the command (literally, If I was an *amir*) and you had the command (lit. if you were an *amir*) who would drive the asses?, the corresponding Eng. proverb being 'Too many cooks spoil the broth'. The pp. is very likely made up by Car. as it appears in his dictionary only. *Amar*, both as a verb and as a noun, if ever it was used very extensively in either sense, has now passed out of the colloquial language, where it is replaced by R. *ordna* or *ikkmanda*, but it has recently been revived in the written language. The verb still survives contextually in the phrase *'k Alla jamar* (for *jekk Alla jamar*), if God wills. A propos

of which, note that both Dess. and Barb. take initial *k* for Ar. كَ. Barb. even takes Fal. to task for suggesting, as Vass. had done before him, that the *k* in question is short for M. *jekk*, if, which is in its turn itself a contraction of Ar. إِنْ يَكُنْ. But Ar. كَ (like) has been completely lost in Maltese, its place being taken by *kif*, Ar. كَيْفَ and M. *jekk* which, in connected speech, is very often shortened into *k*. Thus the Maltese say *'k itrid*, if you wish, (note *i* infixed between *k* and *t* to break up a difficult triconsonantal group) for *jekk trid*; and *'k tiġi* for *jekk tiġi*, if you come; *'k aħna* for *jekk aħna*, if we, and also *'k Alla*, for *jekk Alla*, if God. In both *'k Alla jamar* and the similar phrase *'k Alla jrid*, if God wills, to the Maltese, initial *k* conveys the meaning of *'if'* and not of *'as'*. Phonetically *k* (*k* when followed by two or more consonants) is the weak form of *jekk*, its corresponding strong form.

Amba, tr. v. To make use of something; to require; to need. This defective verb is used only in the present tense and has no other morphological forms. Vass.'s explanation that this verb is short for *għamel bi*, Ar. عَمِلَ بِ is still the best explanation that has been given. The different explanation given by A. Cremona, the Maltese grammarian, in IL-MALTI of September 1939 that it is Ar. أَبَّ with an infixed *m* is unacceptable because in Libyan from which he quotes what he thinks are parallel usages, أَبَّ means simply 'to wish'. As a matter of fact, in this dialect أَبَّ is used instead of أَرَادَ whereas *amba* in Maltese never means to wish, but to be in need of; to have use for something; to require; and is always replaceable by *għamel bi*. For instance, *dal-ktieb x'tambih?* what will you do with this book?, which might be expressed equally well: *dal-ktieb x'tagħmel bih?*. But we never say *nambi niekol* for *irrid niekol*, I want to eat.

Amman This archaic word indicates a near or remote future but according to Car. it indicates a remote future in contradistinction from the time-idea conveyed by *meta* مَتَى which indicates a near future. Vass. gives the following examples of 'near future': *ammân f'nofs inhar*, a mezzodi; *ammân għall-għasar*, sul tardi; *ammân għal fil-għaxija*, verso la notte, and of the 'remote future' *ammân meta tikber*, allorquando crescendo; *ammân fi xjuħitna*, quando diverremo vecchi. Vass. adds after these examples: *Onde questa dizione non à propria significazione, ma soltanto denota tempo, e di lui determina il tempo.* The same explanation is rejected by Fal. Barb. derives M. *ammân* from Ar. أَمَامَ before, in front

of, while Dess. suggests various possible origins for M. *ammân*, but does not decide his preference, these being عَمَّال, at present, or إِبَّان, or أُمَّال, or فِي أَمَانِ اللّٰهِ. Of the various words given by Dess., عَمَّال seems to me to be the origin of the M. word, with interchange of liquids *l* and *n*. For the temporal meaning of عَمَّال, cfr. عَمَّال وَعَمّ يَكْتُب (dialect of Syria), he is writing presently, Hava, and *šâf zálme qâ'ed u 'emmâl yéšrab 'arkīle* (dialect of Palestine – Feghali 'Syntaxe, etc.', p. 44) and عمّال فِي, 'qui est en passe, qui est sur le point de' (Tunis – Beauss.)

B

Bahrad whence *tbahrad* (II Form) int. v. To have a spree, to make merry, to enjoy one's self riotously; to romp. Of dubious origin and omitted by Dess. Barb. thinks it is made up of رَهْدَن + Syrian prefix بـ, which, it will be remembered, is not a characteristic of M. grammar. For a possible origin cp. تَبَهْرَج, to pass, to sweep by with pomp, Hava; 'marcher fastueusement, avec orgueil', Kaz.; 'mettre du faste, de la recherche dans ses vêtements, sa table, son ameublement', Beauss; تَبَهْرِيج, 'faste', Kaz. For change of final *ġ* to *d*, cp. similar change in Maltese in *geġweġ*, to abound, for *gedwed;* Sic. *suggizzioni*, M. *sudizzjoni;* also vice versa. Cp. Lat. *sedia* whence Siculo-Maltese *siġġu*, chair. I have heard also *tbaħraġ* as a variant of *tbaħrad;* this form confirms the origin I have suggested.

Baħħ, child's word to express emptiness, nothing, Fal. But this word, in certain contexts, is also used by adults to emphasize the idea of complete emptiness or solitude; for example, *kollox baħħ; la kont tara ruħ u lanqas tisma' ħoss;* perfect silence; you did not see a soul, nor hear a sound. Children use it as a synonym for 'nothing', 'finished'. Cp. بَحْ, no more, Sp. B., 'there is none!, no more!, all gone' (baby's talk). Dess. gives باه for M. *baħħ*. Ar has also أَبْهَى and بَهَأَ in the sense of 'to empty' (a house)'.

Baħrija, f.n. A kind of bee that is supposed to bring sailors'news which may be good or bad according to its colour – good if it is of a brownish

colour, bad news if dark. Barb. thinks it stands for Ar. بِالْخَيْرِيَّة literally 'with good news'. This explanation does not account for the radical *b* in the M. word, nor does its supposed meaning agree with that of M. *baħrija* which may be the messenger of good or bad news from overseas. Professor P.P. Saydon of the University of Malta thinks that *baħrija* stands for خَبَرِيَّة, news, story, with metathesis of the first two consonants. I think that *baħrija* is a feminine relative adjective from the noun *baħar,* sea, with a nominal function. In this sense the M. meaning is purely local. Beaus. gives بَحْرِي 'variété de faucon'. Dess. gives بَحْرِيَّة the lady sailor, or the Northener.

Baghbas tr. v. To handle roughly; to tamper with; to touch or turn about in the fingers; to spoil something by too much fingering. This quadriliteral verb is obviously denominative from Ar. بَعْبُوص, finger, unlucky affair, spoke in one's wheel, intrigue, whence بَعْبَصَ, to tickle the hind parts, given by Sp. B. who gives also بَعْبَصَ لَهُ الْقَضِيَّة, he put a spoke in his wheel. For semantics cp. verbal use of Eng. 'finger', 'to turn about in the fingers'.

Baghli, adj. 'Dicitur de oleribus pluvia tantum irrigatis, quae sunt sapidissimi succi', Vass. (Cp. M. *qargħa bagħlija, kromba bagħlija*). In this sense, *bagħli* is opposed to *saqwi* (from *saqa,* to irrigate, Ar. سَقَى), irrigated land. The M. meaning agrees with that of بعل in Syrian. M. Feghali in his *Contes, Legendes, Coutumes Populaires du Liban et de Syrie* writes: 'Le dialectal *ba'l* (invariable) désigne un terrain qui n'est pas arrosé artificiellement, soit qu'il se trouve trop élevé pour être touché par l'eau, soit qu'il fasse partie de terrains où l'eau manque en été, comme c'est généralement le cas sur le littoral et dans la region moyenne. En somme *ba'l* est l'opposé de *saqi* 'irrigation, terre arrosée artificiellement'.

Baghtar, tr. v. To tread or plod through mud; to cultivate muddy soil or till it when it is still soaked. Obsolete or rare word of dubious origin. Barb.'s explanation that it is made up of the Syrian prefix أَغْدَرَ + بِـ is unacceptable (see under *bahrad*). For the origin, cp. Ar. بَعْثَرَ or بَحْتَرَ he demolished a water trough or tuned it upside down, Lane, which may have suggested the M. meaning 'to tread or plod through mud' and also 'to cultivate the land when it is soaked and muddy after much rain', Car.

Baqat (form given by Car., but Vass. and Fal. give *baqqat* which is the

only current form known to me) tr. v. To coagulate, to curdle, whence the more commonly used noun *baqta*, curdled milk. Dozy, who did not know Kaz., gives بَقَطَ as a Maghrebinic verb, occurring in Pedro de Alcala' (Sp. Ar.) from Spanish 'pegar', to glue. But cp. بَقَثَ 'Mêler, pétrir le fromage frais appelé إِقْط ' given in Kaz., Barb's explanation that M. *baqqat* corresponds to Ar. عَقَّدَ +Syrian prefix ب rests on a misconception of the grammatical function of the Syrian prefix which I have already pointed out under *bahrad* (q.v.).

Bass, int. v. To break wind. This Maghrebinic verb has nothing to do with فَصَّ as explained by Barb. Cp. *'bass:* cum strepitu pepedit; *bassas* (= M. *bassas* also *basbas*) cum strepitu pedentem reddere, *bassas* (= M. *bassâs*), qui semper cum strepitu pedit', given by H. Stumme in his Tunisian Grammar. Beauss. gives بَصَّ 'péter' (Tunis).

Bellus, m. n. Dess. derives it from Ar. بالاس , a horse cloth; and Barb. from its plural form بُلُس . But Ar. بُلُس in Maltese would be *bolos* not *bellus* (cf. Ar. pl. طُرُق M. *toroq*, roads). I suggest that M. *bellus* derives from *villus*, shaggy hair; whence *vellutus*, hairy, from which we have the Italian *velluto* and Eng. *velvet*, derived from Low Latin *velluetum;* ultimately also from L. *villus* (Zing.). For a similar Ar. word, cp. M. *fellus*, chicken (pl. *flieles*), Ar. فلّوس pl. فلالس , 'poulet, poussin', Beauss., ultimately L. *pullus*.

Benġel, tr. v. To bruise; to make livid. Omitted by Dess. According to Barb. it is made up of Syrian prefix ب + جَلَدَ (see under *bahrad*). *Benġel*, which is Semitic in form but not in origin, is a denominative verb from M. *bringiela*, egg-plant, from Spanish *beranzana* with omission of *r* whence *benġel* for *brenġel*. The initial biconsonantal group in the latter word being phonetically awkward, *r* had to fall out. Of one whose face turns livid or is discoloured as by a bruise, the Maltese say *wiccu sar minn leun il-bringiela*, literally, his face has become of the colour of the *bringiela*. It is also used for a black eye, as in *ghamillu daqsxejn ta' bringiela*, he gave him a good black eye.

Bennen, tr. v. To rock the cradle, whence **benniena**, f.n. cradle. Two very interesting words and in this sense both purely Maltese. For the rare verbal form, cp. بَنَّنَ 'élever un enfant', recorded by Comte de Landberg in his *Glossaire Datinois*, where he gives also تَبَنَّنَ , (M. *tbennen*, to be rocked in the cradle) 'être élevé'. For M. *benniena* cp. Egyptian

بَنَّاني, pigeon hole, Hava. Barb.'s explanation that M. *bennen* is made up of the Syrian prefix ب + *nanna,* Sic. word for sleep, is obviously inadmissible.

Bera, int. v. To look carefully for something lost; to stare; to keep watch, Fal. Also to shine (stars) Car. But the meaning we usually attach to it is 'to shine, generally with excitement (eyes)', whence the derived meaning 'to look inquisitively', used only in the third person sing. and pl. of the Imperfect. According to Dess. *bera* is very likely a variant of Ar. بَرَّقَ (M. *berraq,* to flash, lightning), perhaps influenced by *abra.* Barb.'s inadmissible explanation is that it is made up of the Syrian prefix ب + رَأَى. Prof. Saydon thinks that it may link up with بَهَرَ, to shine, which, as he plausibly points out, in the third person pl. of the Imperfect, by analogy with *fehem* (pronounced *fe:m* with *e:* slightly pharyngalised) to understand, Ar. فَهِمَ would give *jibhru* (cp. *fehem-jifhmu*) in which position M. *h* (ه) is silent. But I do not think this verb is Semitic, not on etymological grounds, for Saydon's suggestion from that point of view is correct, but because, unlike genuine M. verbs of Ar. origin, *bera* is morphologically very defective, its limited use being confined to the third person sing. and pl. of the Imperfect, without further derivatives. The unheard verbal noun *biri,* shining, and the pp. *mibri,* unknown to the spoken language, are certainly made up by Car. with the purpose of increasing the impoverished stock of Semitic Maltese. I think that M. *jibbri – jibbru,* less frequently *jibri – jibru,* is made up of the first two syllables, conforming to patterns of M. verbs with the third radical *j* (ى), of the Italian verb *brillare,* to shine, which conjugated in M. as a loan verb gives *jibbrilla* (= *jibbri* + *lla*), the first two syllables representing the sing. form of the Maltesised verb, with *jibbru* for the pl. Modern Maltese has both *jibbru* and *jibbrilla,* the latter being a later loan when the Maltese ear could assimilate foreign sounds more easily.

Berbaq, tr. v. To squander one's money. Hardly denominative from بَرْبَخ sewer, in the sense 'to pour down a drain or soakaway' as suggested by Dess. Cp. بَرْدَقَ, 'étendre' and تَبَرْدَقَ (M. *tberbaq*), 's'éparpiller: c'est, peut-être le même verbe que le syrien بَذْرَقَ, éparpiller, gaspiller son argent; cp. بَذَرَ' (Landberg: *Glossaire Datinois*). Barb. rightly suggests بَذْرَقَ, to waste, to squander (money), Hava. The form I quoted from Landberg gives us a parallel of the M. metathesis. My

explanation of the change of Ar. *d* into M. *b* is that it is due to the influence of analogy with the quadrilateral patterns which repeat the 3rd radical; for example *żerżaq*, to cause one to slide; *kaxkar*, to drag, etc.

Berfel, tr. v. To trim a dress with ribbon, lace, etc. According to Barb. it is made up of the Syrian prefix ب + رفل. (See remark under *babrad*). The M. verb is obviously denominative from M. *berfir*, a purple cloth, Fal. with which cp. Ar. بِرْفِير from the Greek πορφύρα whence It. *porpora* which in M. becomes *porpra*, a more modern form of the less known *berfir* given by Fal.

Bežlek (also **Bežlaq**) int. v. To suck frequently, Fal. To smack one's lips (sucking baby), Car. Omitted by Dess. Barb. derives it from N. Afr. Ar. بَزُّولَة Maltese *bežżula*, a woman's breast. But this explanation leaves the existence of the 4th radical unexplained. My explanation is that *bežlek* is denominative from the noun *bżieq*, spittle, Ar. بُزَاق with inserted *l* as 3rd radical to denote frequency of action. Note that *bežlek* or *bežlaq* is not only used in the sense of 'to suck frequently' but also in the sense of 'to spit frequently'. In this sense *bežlek* is a synonym of *bežżaq*, 2nd form of *bežaq*, to spit, Ar. بَزَقَ. Another liquid consonant forming quadriliterals from original triliteral roots is *r* which in Ar. frequently interchanges with *l*. Cp. M. *xeblek*, to twine about, from verbal root √XBK, to twine, interweave, and Ar. شَرْبَك from شبك.

Bimbi, also **Bumbu**. Child's word for drink in general, but according to Fal. 'wine'. Car. gives *bimba, ibimbi* as a child's word for 'to drink'. Cp. *mbua*, 'trinken (Kinderstubenwort)', given by Stumme in his Tunisian Grammar and also by Sp. B. in his Grammar of the Egyptian Dialect. Cp. also Sic. *bumbu* (Barb.)

Biswit, a composite word used as a preposition in the sense of 'over against', Fal.; Contra, ex adverso, e regione, ante: *it.* Rimpetto, dirimpetto, in contro, in faccia', Vass. Omitted by Dess. According to Barb. it is made up of the preposition *b* + Fr. *suite*. But *biswit* is Semitic Maltese, the initial consonant being the preposition *bi*, Ar. بِ, and *swit* standing for Ar. سواة, final *t* being the *t marbuta* which explains why *biswit* is always used in construction with a noun or a pronomial suffix. Cp. the following in Bochter quoted by Dozy: بَيْتُهُ فِى سَوَاةِ الجَامِع, 'sa maison est dans l'alignement de la mosquée';

cp. also عَلى سَواءَ, 'droit, directement'. The difference in Maltese is the use of *bi* ب for Ar. في , M. *fi.*

Bixkilla, f.n. A wicker basket, Fal. Barb's explanation that this word derives from Eng. 'basket', without showing how the phonetic change may have taken place, is absurd. Historically, the word, included by Vass. in his Lexicon (1796), antedates the beginning of the English domination in Malta. For its origin, cp. It. *fiscella* from Lat. *fiscella,* dim. of *fiscus,* a basket of wicker work, and for the interchange of *f* and *b,* cp. *fixkel* and *bixkel;* Ar. فَزَعَ and M. *baża',* to fear; Ar. قَفَزَ and M. *qabeż.* The development of post-consonantal *k* in a prevocalic position may be a survival of the *k* sound in Lat. *fiscus;* cp. M. *fisqija,* swaddling clothes from Sic. *fascia;* Lat. *fascia.*

Botbot (as given by Vass., Car., and Fal. but the correct spelling is *bodbod*), m.n. A he-goat. Fal. gives *btabet* and *btiebet* as pl. forms and Vass. also *botbtijiet;* Car. gives *btabet.* The plural form I have always heard used is *bdabat* with *d* as 2nd radical not *t* and unvoiced [*d*] as the 4th radical. It is interesting to note that Vel. beside *botbot* writes also *bodbod.* Dess. thinks this word may be connected with Ar. بُطْبُط (Dozy, a snail), the snail's shell being likened to a ram's horn in the synagogue. To this far-fetched explanation I prefer Barb.'s interesting suggestion that M. *bodbod* (he writes *botbot*) implies a figurative usage of Ar. بَضْبَض pl. بُضَابِض 'strong, robust', Kaz. Phonetically, this form explains the M. pl. *bdabad.* It is also possible that the M. word is an independent local onomatopoeic formation.

Btil (also **Btir**) m.n. Quintessence, Fal. essence, Car. Barb. apparently mistakes it for Ar. فَضِيل . Dess. thinks it is Ar. بَتْل optimum (Freytag). My explanation is that *btil* or *btir,* like *biswit* (q.v.), is made up of two grammatical elements, the preposition *b+tir,* the latter being the modification of Ar. عِطْر sweet-smelling, aromatic, essence (Hava). It will be remembered that in Maltese Ar. ع phonetically disappears except for a consequent pharyngalisation of the following vowel. Presumably عِطْر in Maltese became *atiːr* whence *batir* for *b+atir* and *btir,* with the elision of the first unstressed vowel which must have happened when to the Maltese the composite word suggested one unmodified meaning. Therefore *btir* or *btil* literally means 'with the essence'. Car. gives the M. phrase *btir il-ward,* 'essenza di rose', with which cp. Ar. عِطْرُ ٱلْوَرْد , essence of rose, Hava.

Ċ

Ċaflas, tr. and int. v. To wade, to ford, Fal. and better still, to make a mess scattering water about; also, to work carelessly, Car. Barb's suggestion is that this verb is short for Sic. *ciappa-lassa*, literally, he takes and leaves, referring to an inconstant, changeable person, one who works by fits and starts. Incidentally, the Sic. idiom occurs also in the M. *jaqbad u jitlaq*, but it is certainly far-fetched as an explanation of the M. verb *ċaflas*, with which, for possible origin or connection, cp. Sp. *chafallmejas*, dauber, and *chafallar*, to botch, to bungle, to mend clumsily.

Ċaħtur pl. **Ċħatar**, m. n. An old, unseemly person or thing, Fal., a word of contempt to indicate an abject, mis-shapen or contemptible person, Car. In the sense of general contempt I heard it used in Birgu. Omitted by Dess.; Barb. derives it from Ar. شَخْتُورَة, a boat; in the M. sense, a translation of the Sic. barcazza, contemptuously used to describe an old woman. But cp. شُحْتُول, silly fellow (dialect of Syria), Hava.

Ċajt, collective pl. of *ċajta* f. n. a joke; whence the verb *iċċajta*, to joke and the adj. form *ċajtier*, mirthful, humorous. Dess. suggests Ar. شَوْط (Dozy), Barb. derives it from Eng. *chat* which shows that he is unaware that this word is also given by Vass. 'loquacitas, vaniloquentia, nugae' With M. *ċajta*, cp. Sic. *piato* and *ciaita* from Lat. *placitum*, with *ċ* [č] as the phonetic implication of initial [pl]. Pasqualino explains 'chiaita' as 'ciarla', 'vanità' and 'chiaiteri', with which cp. M. *ċajtier*, 'colui che riporta novella'. For a note on Lat. *placitum* in relation to M. *ċajt* and Sic. *chiaita*, see Giacomo De Gregorio, ST. GL. IT. Vol. 7.

Ċagħak collective pl. of *ċagħka*, f. n. A pebble. There can be no phonetic connection with Ar. زواهق, smooth pebbles, as suggested by Dess. Barb. derives it directly from كَعْكَة pl. كَعْك, cake, biscuit (M. *kagħak*, *kagħka*). M. *ċagħka* is the same word as the Sic. *ciaca:* sassolino rotondo per lo più ad uso di acciottolare, Pasqualino. Giacomo De Gregorio in ST. GL. IT. Vol. 7 writes that he heard it also in Tunis and says that in his opinion, it is the result of Sic. linguistic infiltration. But *ciaca* may well be originally Persian Arabic كَعْكَة, (M. *kagħka*) that wandered back to N. Africa. The Sic. word deriving directly from كَعْكَة, phonetically changed its *k* sound to *ċ* (č), by analogy with Sic. *ch* (phonetically *k*) which often changes to *č* as, for instance, *chiaru* (Lat *clarus*) also *ciaru*, clear, whence M. *ċar*.

Ċappa, f. n. with Semitic pl. *ċapep*. A lump, as *ċappa tamar*, a lump of dates. Barb. derives it from Ar. كُبَّة , the M. correspondence of which is *kobba*, a clew or a ball of thread or yarn. There are some doubtful words in which Ar. *k* changes to *ċ* (č) in Maltese and in these instances *ċ* is positionally final. (Examples *balleċ*, supposed to stand for *b' allek*, by your God, and *sabreċ*, by your patience, for *sabrek*). In this, Maltese agrees with Iraqi, Palestinian Arabic, and also with Sicilian in which the interchange of *k* and c is common. With M. *ċappa*, cp. It. *chiappa* (Sic. *ciappa* as in Maltese), 'cosa da poter afferrare, sporgenza' (Zingarelli), literally, something big you can grasp, which, idiomatically, may tally with the M. usage as in *ċappa tamar*, a lump or handful of dates, as much as you can grasp. Of a stout person, we may say that he is a *ċappa laħam*, a lump of flesh.

Ċaqċaq, int. v. To crackle. Besides Ar. شَقْشَقَ given by Barb. and Dess., who gives also شَكْشَك , for the initial M. sound, cp. Syrian ڇَقْچَقَ , faire résonner ses *qabqâb*, taper des pieds. Faire claquer sa langue, Barth.

Ċarrat, tr. v. To tear, whence *ċarruta*, a rag, pl. *ċraret*, and *ċarru* a shred of cloth or slip of land. Cp. Ar. شَرَطَ , to tear off, and with *ċarruta* cp. Ar. شَرْطُوطَة (pl. شَرَاطِيط), rag. With *ċarru*, occurring only in the phrases *ċarru tax-xoqqa*, a piece of cloth, and *ċarru tar-raba'*, a piece of land, cp. Ar. جَرَّ , 'déchirer dans les sens de la longueur (par exemple une bande d'étoffe); ouvrir (la bouche) toute grande (péjoratif)', W. Març. (p. 257). In the latter sense, cp. M. use of *ċarrat* in *iċarrat ħalqu għal kull xejn*, he shouts (makes a fuss or bursts out laughing) for nothing.

Ċarru: See under **Ċarrat**.

Ċellaq, tr. v. To soil, to dirty. Omitted by Dess. Barb. derives it from Ar. شَلَّقَ , to fall. I think M. *ċellaq* is a denominative verb from the current M. word *xlieqa*, exulceration at the corners of the lips (Fal.) suggesting physical uncleanliness. Of a child spluttering liquid food over its face, we say *ċellaq ħalqu, ħalqu mċellaq*. M. *xlieqa* links up with Ar. شَلَقَ , to split lengthwise (Hava).

Ċerċer, int. v. To be in tatters, to go about begging, Fal. To wander aimlessly from place to place, to idle one's time away, going from one place to another, and *ċerċur* pl. *ċrieċer*, a poor wretch, a beggar, Fal. a person dressed shabbily, tattery. Dess. gives *ċerċir* only, the verbal noun, which he links up with Ar. شَرْشَرَة , fringe (Wortabet). Barb's explanation is that it is from Fr. *chercher*. But M. *ċerċer* is obviously a Semi-

tic quadriliteral made up of the repetition of North African biconsonantal base جَرّ , to rend. See under *ċarrat*.

Ċiera, pl. *ċwieri*, f. n. mien, look, Fal. As explained by Barb. the M. word is certainly the Sic. *ciera*. It is interesting, however, to compare with It. *cera* (from Lat. *cerea*, Zingarelli), Sic. and M. *ciera*, the Syrian Arabic چَهْرَة explained by Bart. 'air du visage, physionomie.'

Ċirċ, m. n. Misty, drizzling weather, Fal. Omitted by Dess. Derives from Ar. شَرْشَرَ , to let out water, by Barb. But for the real origin, cp. N. Afr. Ar. شرش , 'mistral, vent du nord', Beauss.

Ċlamit, collective n. Brick. Both Dess. and Barb. derive it directly from Ar. قَرْمِيد , a Greek loanword. The latter takes Sutcliffe to task for not suggesting that Ar. ق corresponds also to M. *ċ*. But the M. word derives directly from the Sicilian of Messina, *ciaramita*, which, like Ar. قَرْمِيد , is also a Greek loanword. The following note is quoted from Giac. De Gregorio ST. GL. Vol. 7: 'Traina is wrong in explaining *ciaramita* as 'potsherd'. It is very commonly used in the North of Sicily to indicate a brick; it is almost unknown in the West. When I was personally assisting at various works of masonry in the province of Messina, I always heard the mason call bricks *ciaramiti*, and naturally *pezzi di ciaramiti* and also *ciaramit*, the fragments of bricks. The etymology is therefore the Greek *keramis*. Gabriele Maria d'Aleppo and Calveruso, in proposing Ar. شَرَمَ , to split, have been misled by Traina's definition, nor do I care for the opinion of Amari who, although he was a Sicilian, lived always outside Sicily'.

Ċpar, m. n. Mist, Fal., whence the denominative verb *ċajpar*, to render misty, to discolour, to make sallow. Omitted by Dess. Barb.'s suggestion that it derives from Ar. غُبَار , dust, creates serious phonetic difficulties which he leaves unexplained. Ar. غ never changes to *ċ* [č] in Maltese nor do we usually expect in S.M. voiced *b* to be unvoiced by a preceding voiced consonant. My suggestion is that *ċpar* is not Semitic, as we can judge by the criterion of its initial consonant group, unknown in Semitic Maltese, and the pattern of its verbal derivative which, according to S.M. analogy, should give *ċappar*. Note for an interesting comparison with Sp. *chaparrear*, to rain heavily, to pour. One should note that heavy rain and mistiness may be semantically associated. My tentative explanation is that M. *ċpar*, ultimately may link up with L. *pluere*, pluviar (cp. Fr. pleuvoir, It. piovere), with initial

Romance consonant group changed to *ċ* (cp. M. *ċajt* from Lat. *platus*) and *v* changed to unvoiced *b* as in *ċempel* from It. *cembalo*. The interchange of *v* and *b* is a common feature of Sicilian, supposed to be due to Greek influence. Cp., for instance, Sic. *burdunaru* (M. *burdnar*) and *vurdunaru*.

D

Dali, adv. Very often; unceasingly, Fal. Dess. derives it from Ar. دَاوَلَ, to alternate, but cp. M. usage, *dali jokrob*, Car., he groans continually, with Ar. ظَلَّ يَفْعَلُ, to continue to do a thing. Kaz. explains that ظَلَّ 's'emploie comme une sorte de verbe auxiliaire suivi d'un autre verbe a l'aoriste'. This agrees with the rare M. usage in the example given by Car. As this is now an obsolete word, very likely little known also when it was noted by Vass. who explains 'particula haec tempus ut plurimum Imperfectum indicat', it is possible that we should read *dalli* for *dali*, final *i* instead of *a* being the result of a regressive assimilation of the vowel *i* or semi-vowel *j* in the 3rd person sing. masc. pronominal prefix added to the stem of the verb in the imperfect tense.

Dan, this, masculine demonstrative pronoun, with feminine *din* (and common plural *dawn*, these). Variants are *da, di,* and *daw*, with *hedan* or *heda, hedin* or *hedi, hedawn* or *hedaw*, all forms still in current use, those with initial *he*, being confined to priests' sermons for oratorical effect. Barb. (p. 108) explains final *n* as a purely euphonic, non-Semitic element, formed by analogy with Sicilian, which also adds *n* as suffix to the personal pronouns, and gives as example *iuni* for *io* (I), *tuni* for *tu* (thou), etc. But linguistically, the demonstrative pronouns belong to the less perishable or influenceable element of the language and therefore the origin has to be sought within the Semitic group.

Note that whereas the ordinary demonstrative pronouns in Arabic are ذَا, M. *da*, ذِى, M. *di*, there are other instances of dialectal Arabic in which the demonstrative pronouns are compounded with the suffix *n*. Cp. also Biblical Aramaic דְּנָה, Nabatean דנה, Sabean דן, Phoenician זן. With the Maltese plural forms *dawn* and *hedawn*, cp. *badun* (Tripoli), *hadun* (Morocco), *hadhuna* (Tunis), given by Lacy O'Leary in his 'Comparative Grammar of the Semitic Languages'.

Dagħa, int. v. To swear, blaspheme; *dagħa bi*, to swear by, as *jidgħi b'Alla*, he swears by God; blasphemes God. In this sense, cp. Ar. دَعَا بِ , to call a person or thing by a name. Whereas Ar. دَعْوَة besides 'curse' may mean 'a mere call' or 'invitation' and دَعَاوَة , 'prayer to God', M. *dagħwa* has got only the first meaning 'a curse', also 'blasphemy'.

Dagħbien, n. A whirlwind, boisterous wind; *dagħbien ta' l-ilma*, waterspout, Fal. Barb.'s suggestion that we have here an adjective from زَوْبَعَة , storm, is not acceptable. Cp. Ar. دَاعِب , 'qui coule avec rapidité (se dit de l'eau, d'un torrent, quand le cours précipité de ses vagues ressemble au trot rapide du cheval', Kaz. Cp. also Ar. دَوَاعِب , (pl.) 'flots, vagues qui se précipitent les unes à la suite des autres', Kaz., from Ar. دَعَبَ , 'couler avec force, fontaine, rivière', Beauss., 'couler (se dit des liquides)', Kaz. Cp. also دُعْبِيَّة , a high wind (Lane) suggested by Dess.

Daqs, n. and adv. Size; adverbially 'as much as, about'. The explanation given by Dess. and Sutcliffe that it derives from Ar. طَقْس , a Greek loan word τάξις, rite, ceremonies, tax, contribution, and Barb.'s explanation, that it derives from the Ar. قَدَّ أَيْش or أَيْش قَدّ must be rejected in favour of its derivation from '*tágəz* تقز 'à peu près semblable à' (par l'âge, la taille, la valeur, le poids): *ulêdi u – wuldak dgûl tágəz wâḥed* 'mon fils et ton fils sont de même taille', Boris G. 'Lexique du Parler Arabe des Marazig' (Cp. M. *ibni w ibnek daqs wieḥed*). It is interesting to note that *tágəz* is used also adverbially with the meaning of 'environ, approximativement', a usage which has its correspondent in M. *daqs* (ex. *kien hemm daqs erbgħin ruħ*, there were about forty persons).

Dardar, tr. v. To nauseate; also, to render muddy (water), Fal. According to Barb. it links up with Ar. تَرْتَرَ , to stir, whence the M. meaning 'to turn water murky, turbid' which is more satisfactory than Dess.'s suggested Ar. دَرْدُور , whirlpool. But for the same M. dialectal *d* for Ar. *t*, cp. N. Afr. Ar. دَرْدَرَ , troubler l'eau, Beauss.

Dejjud, m.h. A wittol, cuckold, Fal. Barb.'s fanciful explanation is that the M. word is short for Ar. ذَا أَوْ ذِى الْيَهُود , literally 'this Jew or this Jewess', which, he tells us, is a phrase current in Syria 'to designate the Jews' custom to drive their womenfolk to prostitution for

money'. For the correct origin, cp. Ar. دَيَّثَ, to abase, to revile, Hava. Cp. also دَيُّوث, 'homme qui n'est pas jaloux de sa femme, et qui se fait même son entremetteur', Kaz. The M. word as given by Vass. and as copied from him by later lexicographers, is written with a final *d*, unvoiced in this position, but reappearing in its original phonetic value in the feminine and pl. patterns *dejjuda, dejjudin*, but there is no other instance of Ar. ث becoming *d* in Maltese. It is possible that Vass. made up the pl. fem. patterns himself.

Digment, adv. Immediately, instantly, Fal. Barb.'s explanation, which was given also by Stumme in his *Maltesische Studien*, that the M. adv. is the modification of Sic. *dignamenti*, It. *degnamente*, worthily, justly, is inadmissible. The meaning is altogether different. M. *digment*, pronounced and written also *dikment*, is an instance of mixed phraseology. It is short for *dak il-mentri*; It. *in quel mentre*, still used in the sense of 'immediately, instantly'. The change of *k* to *g* is understandable in the light of the phonetic function of the liquids in Romance Maltese. For the apocopation of *mentri* in original *dak il-mentri*, cp. *drament* and *dment*, as long as, from It. *di mentre*.

Din, m.n. Religion; natural disposition. In the latter sense, we say *raġel ta' din ħażin*, a man of bad character, but in the first sense the word belongs to literary Maltese, the current substitute being the loanword *reliġjon*. It still occurs frequently in the mild oath *reħ dinek*, corruption of *aħraq dinek* or *jaħraq dinek*, burn your faith, or curse (dishonour on) your faith, or cursed be your faith, a historical reminder of the religious animosity between the Moslem and the Christian Maltese. To the popular imagination, *din* in the sense of religion has something unpleasant about it; a non-Christian atmosphere. It is interesting to note a similar 'mental attitude' to this word amongst the Christians of Syria amongst whom, according to Feghali (Contes etc. du Liban et de Syrie p. 191), le mot *din*, 'religion, croyance' s'emploie aujourd'hui dans une foule d'expressions dialectales avec un sens beaucoup moins rigoriste que celui qu'y etait attaché autrefois; en effet, *din* rentrait dans les blasphemes que l'on proferait contre Dieu, ou la religion de celui qui l'on voudrait injurier'.

Dolf, m.n. Plane-tree. Cp. Ar. دُلْب, and note change of Ar. ب to M. *f*, the opposite of what happens in M. *beża'*, Ar. فَزَع. As the final consonant group occurs in a similar position also in some M. words, (cp. M. *ġorf*, giant), the change may be due to the possible influence or contamination of meaning of Ar. دُلْف, pl. of دَلُوف fruitful palm-tree, Hava.

Falda, f. n. A piece of veal generally thick enough for stuffing. With this interesting word which has not been recorded in the M. dictionaries, but which is still very commonly used, cp. Ar. فِلْذَة , a piece of meat, from فَلَذَ , to cut a slice of meat, Hava, and It. *falda* which Zingarelli explains 'carne attaccata alla lombata e alle cosce', derived by him from German *Falte*. Maltese usage points to an Italian origin.

Fantas (also *fantaż*), tr. v. To fancy, to imagine; to build castles in the air, whence *tfantas*, he was offended, he took offence, became sulky. Not in Vass., Vel. and Fal. but is given by Car. It is interesting to note that this semiticised Latin verb, ultimately Greek, occurs also in N. African in the Maltese sense. Cp. تَفَنْطَز être arrogant; faire le gros dos, فَنْطَازِيَة (with which cp. M. *fantasija*, imagination, whim) 'ostentation, parade, apparat, éclat', Beauss. For usage, cp. M. *jitfantas mixxejn*, 'he is easily offended'.

Faqsi, m. adj. Carroty (hair) or person having such hair, Car. In Vass. Vel. and Fal. 'productive, prolific' in which sense the word links up with M. *faqas*, to hatch, Ar. فَقَسَ . Not in Dess. The origin of *faqsi* in the sense of 'carroty, red-haired', is dubious. It occurs in the proverb: *għall-faqsi xejn la tistaqsi*, you need not make enquiries about a red-haired person, implying that you must expect such a person to be difficult or pig-headed. Another belief is that a red-haired child is illegitimate; for this reason, he is sometimes known as the 'Son of the Wind' or the 'Son of the Alcove'. M. *faqsi*, in this sense, perhaps, links up with Ar. فَقِيع , red-faced, Hava, from فَقَع , to be intensely red, which in M. would be *faqgħi*, the *s* being explainable as originally a device to make *faqgħi* rhyme with *tistaqsi*.

Felaħ, int. v. To be strong; *felaħ għal*, to be able to cope with. The M. verb has completely lost the Ar. meaning 'to till the ground', though this semantic connection is obvious in the M. meaning cognate with that of فَلَحَ , 'prospérer' (Beauss). For the restricted M. meaning cp. also Ar. أَفْلَحَ , 'se conduire vaillamment', Dozy, to be successful, Hava.

Felles, int. v. To coin money, Vass., Fal. and *files*, to make money, to become rich, Car. For contrast of meaning, cp. Ar. فَلَّسَ , to declare one to be bankrupt, and أَفْلَسَ , to be penniless, Hava. For similar contrast of meaning, cp. M. *jies*, hope, Ar. يَأْس , despair.

Fesfes, int. v. To whisper in the ear. This M. verb, still in current use, is phonetically a variant of *sefsef* as suggested by Dess. but not of *wezwez* also suggested by him. For the same M. form, cp. N. Af. Ar. فسفس , 'parler bas, chuchoter', Beauss.

Fexfex, int. v. To hiss, (said of boiling oil in the frying oan, etc.) also to be foolish, hasty, whence *fixxfixx*, carelessly, and *imfexfex*, foolish, hasty. Not in Vass., Vel., Fal. or Dess. Cp. Tangier Ar. فشفش , pétiller (en parlant d'un liquide chargé d'acide carbonique)', Març. p. 414. For the sense 'to be foolish', cp. also Ar. فشغش , to be weak-minded, Hava.

Fiet, tr. v. To cheat; occurring contextually in the proverb: *il-għadu biex fietek biesek, u int biex tfutu aqleb fuqu*, 'the enemy has kissed you to deceive you, you will cheat him by attacking him suddenly'. Morphologically, the nearest form is Ar. أفاتَ, to cause one to miss, but, semantically the M. verb is nearer to It. *fottere*, to deceive, occurring also in later M. as *fotta* and the Latin origin *futuo*.

Fitel, m. n. The space between the thumb and the forefinger; half a span. Not in the M. dictionaries; but I heard the word used by Gozitan children when measuring the distance between one marble ball, etc. and another. In this sense, cp. Ar. فِتر , having the same meaning as in Maltese (Hava). Note segholation of the last two radicals in Maltese (Ar. *tr* = m: *tel*).

Fonqla, m. and f. n. A bore, Fal. A person hard to please. Not in Dess. Cp. Ar. فَنَّقَ , to make a person lead a soft and delicate life, whence فنق , brought up delicately (girl), Hava. I think the M. word stands for *fonqa*, the fem. pattern being applied to either gender as *għaġba*, a person that exaggerates or makes a fuss about everything, for *għaġeb* also used for both genders. The liquid consonant *l* in this case would be a phonetic development as in *xeblek*, to intertwine from √XBK and *meslaħ* (q. v.) from √MSH.

G

Gami, m.n. Friar's cowl, arum Fal. Not in Dess. For origin, cp. Ar. loan word قَرَانِيَا , Cornelian tree, dogwood, Hava, from the Gk. κράνειᾶ.

Gażaża, f.n. Baby's dummy (teat). Not in the Maltese dictionaries. If Semitic, cp. قازوزة , 'vase à boire; bouteille', Kaz., and *gażażu*, falcon, given by Stumme in his Tunisian Grammar, perhaps so called because it can be attached to the feeding bottle.

Gellux, m.n. A young animal, a calf, Fal. Dess. gives قَلَاش , small, short, Freytag. For the Maltese sense, cp. N. African قلواش , 'chevreau d'un an', Beauss.

Gendus, m.n. A bull, a young ox, Fal. Not in Dess. For origin, cp. Berber *agenduz*, 'veau', Destaing, and N. African فنطوس pl. فناطس , 'bouvillon, veau de deux ans', Beauss.

Gerbeb, tr. v. To roll, to twist. Not in Dess. Cp. Ar. كَرَبَ , to twist (a rope), Hava, and note pattern-assimilation of a historical triradical to a quadriliteral by repetition of 3rd radical.

Gerfex, tr. v. To cobble, to bungle; to confound, to mix, Fal. It also means to scrape, as hens do when looking for seeds, etc. Dess. gives Ar. كَرْفَجَ as Algerian under *kerfex*, which is a variant of *gerfex*. Cp. also Ar. كَرْفَأَ , 'se mêler les uns aux autres, être pêle-mêle', Kaz.; خَرْفَشَ , 'parler mal' (Dozy) with which cp. M. *kliem imgerfex*, 'muddled talk.'

Germed, tr. v. To blacken with soot. Dess. gives Ar. جَلْمَدَ as Tunisian. Perhaps the verb is connected with Ar. قَرْمَدَ to plaster with mud; to pave (a house) with bricks, Hava.

Gerżuma, f.n. Throat. Cp. N. Afr. قرجومة , gorge, gosier, Beauss. and note change of Ar. ج to M. *ż* as in the cognate Ar. verb كَرْزَمَ , 'faire le repas de midi', and its derivative Ar. كُرْزُم , 'glouton', Kaz.

Ginda, tr. v. To bite; child's word. Not in Dess. Cp. Ar. كَنَدَ , to cut a thing, Hava.

Godla, f.n. That part of the body which is composed of muscles; whence M. adj. *godli*, robust, muscular, Car. Besides Ar. جُدْل , robust, firm, given by Dess., cp. جِدْل , 'membre quelconque du corps; tendon (des mains ou des jambes)', Kaz.; member, sinew (Hava). Cp. also Lat. *condulus* and Gk. κόνδυλος, a knuckle or joint of the finger.

Gondalla, f.n. A bump, a swelling caused by a fall, Fal. Not in Dess.

For possible origin, cp. Ar. جَنْدَلَ, 'jeter par terre', and Ar. جَنْدَل, 'pierre', Kaz., and for the form, cp. rare Ar. nominal pattern فُعْلَّة, (ex. غُلَّبَة). Consonant *n* in this case would be a non-radical euphonic insertion.

Ġ

Ġardam, tr. v. To wear off. Not in the Maltese dictionaries. I heard the word used in the passive participle in Gozo *(mġardam)* in the sense of 'worn off'. For semantics, cp. usage of Eng. '(rocks) eaten away'. Cp. Ar. جَرْدَمَ, to eat, Hava, 'ronger un os garni de viande', Barth., and *mdjardam* pp., 'depenaillé, en lambeaux', Barth. Cp. also the original triliteral verb جَرِدَ, to be threadbare (clothes); to be worn out (clothes) to lose one's hair (man, animal), whence M. *ġarad*, to gnaw, Car., *nagħġa ġarda*, woolless sheep, and *art ġarda*, barren or dry ground, Fal.

Ġarrajja, f.n. Skein, Fal. Not in Dess. and Barb. For the nearest M. meaning, cp. Ar. جَرَّايَة, 'roulette', Dozy.

Ġemġem, int. v. To begin to cry, to wet the cheeks with tears; whence *ġemġim il-għajnejn*, shedding of tears, Fal. Not in Dess. For the origin cp. Ar. أَجَمَّ, to let water flow; جَمَّ, to collect in a well (water); and جَمَّمَ, to fill to excess, Hava.

Ġigna also *ċingna* as given by Fal.; *gingna* by Car. and *ġiekna* as is most frequently heard in Gozo. Timid, abject, contemptible. Invariable adjective. Not in Dess. Cp. جنكنة *'djengana*, mot invariable' meaning 'ladre, chiche', Barth.

Ġileb, m.n. Shears, Car. not in Vass.; Vel. and Fal. The radicals of this word, not in classical Arabic or its dialects, occur in Aram. גְּלַב, Assyr. *galabu*, Syriac ܓܠܒ and Phoenician גלב.

Ġilba, militia, Fal. shoal (of fish), Car. According to Dess. perhaps it stands for جَلَّابَة, a form unknown in Arabic. For the M. meaning cp. جَلْبَة, 'troupeau de moutons ou de boeufs; harde, bande de gazelles', Beauss., from جَلَبَ, to assemble (crowd), Hava.

Ġuġu, baby's word for cheese. Not in Dess. Cp. Berber *tsutsu, cuccu,* baby's word for 'couscous', Destaing.

Ġwejjed, m.adj. Quiet, tranquil, Fal. Diminutive form of unused *ġajjed* (Ex. *tajjeb/twajjeb*) 'good' kind hearted. Perhaps connected with Ar. جَوِيد , fem. جُوَيِّدَة , chez les Druzes, l'initié qui est absorbé dans les choses de la religion', Dozy.

H

Hebeż, int. v. To go backward, to recede, Fal. To move or shrink back, to be taken aback Car. Dess. gives Ar. هَبَزَ in the sense of 'to die' (Freytag), 'mourir d'une mort subite', Kaz., perhaps influenced by *qabeż*, to jump, Ar. قَفَزَ .

Herra, f. n. Rudeness; violence. Dess. suggests Ar. حَرَى , to decrease, Hava. But cp. Ar. هَرَّ , to be ill-natured, Hava. No such meaning is recorded by Beauss.

Herwel, tr. v. To drive mad, Fal. According to Dess. this word looks like a denominative from Ar. حَرُون , restive. I derive it from Ar. هَرْوَل, 'aller au pas gymnastique', Beauss., to hurry in walk, Hava, whence the figurative or derived M. meaning 'crazy' for *mherwel*, the description being generally applied to a person who does everything in a hurry without sufficient thinking.

Hisa (also *isa*), sing. imperative with pl. *hisaw* (also *isaw*), come on!, quick!, Fal. Conjugated in the imperative and Perfect in the sense of 'to hurry', but otherwise defective, it is explained by Dess. and Barb. as a variant of *issa*, Ar. السَّاعَة . But cp. هَسَعَ , 'properavit celer fuit', Frey, to hurry on, to be quick, Hava.

Habrek, int. v. To endeavour, Fal. To be diligent; active; to do one's best, Dess. explains *ħabriek*, industrious, perhaps هَبْرَك, perfect, (Frey.) and حركك, busy (Dozy). But cp. the 4th form of Ar. حَبَكَ, to do a work carefully, Hava, and for insertion of *r* as an additional radical, cp. Ar. شَرْبَك, M. *xeblek* for Ar. شَبَكَ.

Hadem, tr. v. To work, the meaning of Ar. خَدَمَ being 'to serve, to minister to (a person or thing), to last (garment)'. For M. meaning cp. Marçais, note (p. 276): *hdem* Ar. خَدَمَ 'signifie "travailler"; c'est le mot commun maghribin dans ce sens (aussi maltais et déjà andalou)... se retrouve dans l'Arabie du Sud.'

Hafi, said of someone who is always aimlessly wandering about. As *ħafi* in the sense of bare-footed makes no sense, it is possible that it stands for Ar. خافٍ, 'occulte, caché, clandestin', Beauss., Kaz., الخافي, 'les demons' (Kaz.) thus containing a reference to some ancient superstition. It is also possible that in this sense *ħafi* is the present participle of *ħaf-iħuf*, to roam about, formed by analogy with verbs *tertiae radicalis infirmae.*

Hajbur, m. n. Low, misty drizzling clouds, Fal. Not given by Dess. and Barb. Cp. Ar. حَبِير, 'nuage qui offre des raies blanches et noires', Kaz.

Hajz!, an exclamation used in driving away pigs, Fal. It is also used to indicate disgust or nausea; cp. *ħajz għalik!*, fie on you!, how disgusting you are! Not in Dess. Barb. explains it as a contraction from *ħanżir*, pig; Ar. خِنْزِير. For origin cp. Ar. إخْسَ عليك, shame on you, Elias; cp. also خَسَأَ, to drive away (a dog) Hava.

Halla, f. n. Stack, pile of grain; *ħalla baħar*, billow. Barb. and Dess. derive it from حَلَّة, big basket. I suggest also هَلَّ, to fall heavily (rain), هَلَّة pl. هَلَل, rain, Hava. For correspondence of M. *ħ* to Ar. ه cp. *ħarab* for Ar. هَرَبَ, to run away.

Hallata Ballata pell-mell. For the M. idiom, not given by Dess. cp. Syrian *khelt belt*, 'hommes et femmes pêle-mêle', *khilt mlīt*, 'pêle-mêle', Barth.

Halliel, m.n. Thief; robber. Barb. suggests أَخَلَّ, to injure a person, Hava. For M. meaning cp. 10th form of حَلَّ, 's'approprier le bien d'autrui quand on n'y a aucun droit', Dozy. Barth. explains it 'trouver

licite de s'emparer de qqe; s'approprier le bien d'autrui'. And Fagnan explains 4th Form 'regarder come licite la violation.' Note that in Maltese Ar. 4th form is rendered by 2nd form (M. *ħallel*, to consider one a thief, whence *ħalliel*, thief).

Hanxul, m.n. A small root, Fal. Not in Dess. Barb. links it up with أُصُول, roots, a phonetic absurdity. Cp. Ar. خِنْشار, fern (plant), Hava, whence M. *ħanxul* with assimilation of Ar. *r* to *l* in Maltese.

Harira, f.n. Corn pimpernel (*anagallis arvensis*) Cp. Ar. غُرار and غُرارَة (*cressa cretica*) given by Dr. Ahmed Issa Bey in his 'Dictionnaire des Noms des Plantes' (Le Caire, 1930).

Harxajja (also *ħorxa* according to Fr. Magri, as quoted by Barb.) corn-field madder, Fal. Cp. Ar. خَرْشَ pl. خِرّاش, species of cucumber (dialect of Egypt), Hava.

Hawtel, int. v. To exert oneself; to do one's best. According to Barb. this verb is a corruption of إِحْتَالَ, to use deceit, 8th form of حَالَ. But cp. Ar. خَتَلَ, to deceive, Hava, and خَوْتَل, ingenious, Sal., with which cp. M. *ħawtiel*, industrious; diligent; thrifty.

Haxken, tr. v. To press one against (the wall, etc.), to hem in. Not in Dess. Unexplained by Barb. who thinks that 'tale verbo manca dai diz. Arabi'. But cp. Ar. حَشَكَ, to be filled (udder); to throng (crowd), Hava, and for a nearer M. meaning, cp. Syrian حَشَكَ, 'serrer ou gêner (des personnes assises) en prenant place parmi elles', Barth. For final *n* as an additional radical, cp. also M. *hewden*, to rave, from Ar. هَذَى, to rave, to speak deliriously, Hava. M. *ħaxken* derives from the triliteral √HXK expanded to a quadriliteral by the further insertion of *w* as a second radical.

Hbiberija, f.n. Friendship. The Semitic form is *ħbubija*, generally confined to the written language. *Hbiberija* is a structurally mixed word with a Romance suffix (*ħbib* for original *ħbub* + R. prefix *erija*). For other examples of structurally mixed words, cp. *żaqqiqerija*, gluttony; *imqarbizza*, naughtiness; *inkejjuż*, stubborn; *meruż*, contradictious; *emmnut*, believed; *skennut*, sheltered; *sakranazz*, drunkard; *klubiltà*, ravenousness; *xemxata*, sunstroke; *mawrata*, a walk; tenor (of life); *stennar*, awaiting.

Holoq, int. v. To be created, Fal. To be born. *Kont għadek anqas ħloqt meta jien kont naħdem f'dak ix-xogħol*, you had not yet been born when I was doing the work. *Ma ħoloqx*, he has not grown up; has remained

physically undeveloped. In this sense, M. *ħoloq* is passive خُلِقَ of *ħalaq*, خَلَقَ to create. Cp. *bloq*, 'naître; dans ce sens, le mot se retrouve dans le Sud marocain et au Sénégal; *bloq*, naître, représente sûrement le passif خُلِقَ qui apparaît avec le même sens dans des textes du moyen âge. En Algérie, le mot n'est guère employé dans le sens de 'naître', que dans l'expression *melli-bloqt*, depuis que je suis né', W.Març. p. 284.

I

Indokra, tr. v. To keep watch. Barb. derives it from Sic. *aducchiari* or *aducchirari* or *nducchirari* or *nducchiari*, to eye, and Stumme from *riguardare*. I am inclined to think that the M. verb links up with Sic. *indagare*, to inquire, to investigate with *k* for unvoiced *g*, whence *nindokra*, I keep watch, for *n* + *indokra*, the latter part being the Romance pattern of the imperative whence by the addition of Semitic prefixes, derives the present tense patterns of loan-verbs by analogy with Semitic conjugations.

Isa, quick, see *bisa*.

Issajja, tr. v. To look out for, to watch the movements of somebody, lie in wait for someone with the intent of approaching him or attackinghim, etc. This word occurring in Vass. (stare osservando od aspettando) is not given by Dess. Barb.'s explanation that it is an 'adattamento sulla 5a forma andalusa dal verbo inglese *see* guardare' is preposterous. Cp. instead Ar. ضَيَّعَ , (colloquial) to lead out of the way, Salomé, initial *ss* in Maltese being the assimilation of *t* + *s* of the 5th form of the Verb. Cp. also تَضَيَّعَ , to be led astray, Hava.

Issolla, int. v. To cut for a sample, to mark (herbage), Fal. Not in Dess. To estimate, to evaluate, Car. Explained by Barb. as Sic. *assiddari* o *siddari*, to cut into slices, a word unknown to Mortillaro. The M. verb may link with Ar. سَلَأَ , to pay, Hava, 'payer à quelqu'un son argent sur-le-champ', Kaz. From the radical of this verb Maltese has also *sila*, butter, Ar. سِلَا .

Issotta, tr. v. To pelt. Not in Dess. Derived from زَكَّ , to hurl, by Barb.

But initial Ar. *ǯ* does not change to *s* in Maltese. If this verb is Semitic at all, its vocalic sequence is Romance. Cp. Ar. صَتَّ, 's'attaquer à quelqu'un, attaquer par des paroles violentes ou injurieuses', Kaz. A possible Romance origin is Sic. *saittari*, to hurl, denominative verb from *saiitta*, arrow, from Lat. *sagitta*.

Ittoffa, int. v. To push (in a crowd); not given by the Maltese dictionaries. Cp. Ar. طَفَّة, a crowd, Sp. B., and طفّ, 'se jeter sur quelqu'un', Dozy. But like that of *issotta* (q.v.), its vocalic sequence is Romance and the similarity in the suggested comparison may be a matter of sheer coincidence. On the other hand, the nearest Sic. form *tuffari* means 'to submerge' which makes the semantic connection a little remote.

Iżża(+ ħajr), int. v. To thank; now mainly confined to written Maltese and prayers, its place in the spoken language being taken by *irringrazzja* (<It. ringraziare,) is linked up with Ar. عَزَّ, to be dear, rare, precious (Hava) by Barb. But Dess.'s explanation that M. *niżżi(ħajr)*, I render thanks, stands for *nigżi* from Ar. جَزَى, to requite for good or evil, (Hava) is the correct explanation, the more so, as there is a similar dialectal idiom. Cp. Ar. جَزَى, 'récompenser, يَجزِى (on prononce ordinairement يَزِّى); جَازَاهُ خَيرًا, il le remercie', Beauss., M. *iżżi ħajr*.

J

Jaqq! Interiezione esprimente schifo, Car. This exclamation may be connected with Ar. لَكَّ (لَكَّكَ), 'ennuyer', (Beauss) with the replacement of *l* by *j* (ى). Another possible origin is that it results from the conjunction of *ja* with initial *q* in the phrase *ja qażquż*, you pig!, frequently used as an exclamation to indicate disgust.

Jassu, exclamation. Well done! That's right! (child's word), Fal. According to Car. 'voce che si dice ai bambini quando si vuol incoraggiare a far qualche cosa specialmente a star ritti e camminare, dare i primi passi, corrisponde nell'uso all'italiano *bravo! Jassu għalik!* bravo a te! *Jassu għaċ-ċkejken tiegħi*, bravo al mio piccino!' Not in Dess. Accord-

ing to Barb. it is an apocopation of Ar. يَا أَلسَّلَام , '(lett. – oh! salute), che vien detta generalmente col senso di meraviglia e come un applauso a qualcuno, che ha fatto bene.' The explanation is far-fetched and unlikely. I suggest Ar. يَسَّ , to journey, to go on (man), (Hava) the meaning of which links up with the implied M. meaning of *jassu,* you have walked well, go on walking, said to the toddling child by way of encouragement.

Jekk, f. Barb. follows Stumme M.S. (p. 107-108) who explained it as a reduction of *hekda,* Ar. هٰكَذَا . According to Dess. 'it is far more likely for يَكُون or for إِنْ كَانَ , or for apocopated إِنْ يَكُنْ '. One should note that *in ikun* in the sense of 'if' occurs in Sp. Ar. I think Dess.'s explanation more plausible. The process involved would be *'in ikun,* whence *jin ikun,* with a possible further shortening *jenik* finally *jekk* by internal absorption of liquid *n.*

Jies, m. n. Hope; confidence. Ar. يَأْس , despair, the meaning being quite the opposite of Maltese. The M. expression *qata' jiesu,* he gave up hope, occurs also in Tunisian with the same meaning. L. Machuel in his Ed-Dalil (p. 7) gives قَطَعَ الْأَيَاس , 'il désespera'.

Jiġifieri, invariable particle meaning 'that is to say', also *tiġifieri* (Vass.); it amounts to, derived from Ar. جَفَرَ , to be widened, by the late Dr. J. Micallef (see 'Journal of the University of Malta Literary Society', Oct. 1937). Dess. writes *jiġifieri,* formerly written in two words *jiġi jfieri.* The latter word has the form of جَافَرَ , 3rd form but only in the 5th Form has that verb a meaning that would suit the Maltese. Stumme (M.S. 112) wonders whether the word is Semitic at all and not merely It. *cifrare.* I suggest that the M. word is made up of the verb *jiġi* يَجِي + Rom. *affari* (Sic. affari). In modern Maltese, one still says *il-kont jiġi affari ta' lira,* the bill amounts to about £1, whence M. *jiġifieri,* involving this process: *jiġi affari jiġ(i) (a)ffari* > *jiġi fieri* with *a:* changing to *ie* (iɘ) by analogy with the إِمَالَة . For the reduction of a historically long consonant to a one consonant sound, Cp. M. *stwiel* (q. v.).

Kaċiċlu, m. n. Witless; short-witted; shallow-pated. Not in the Maltese dictionaries, but Car. gives its variant, *kaċiċu*, sciocco, babbino. *Lu*, which is either a R. suffix (It. uolo) used to emphasize contempt, or a dative Semitic pronominal suffix, appears in other words formed from the Perfect Tense of verbs, third person sing. masculine gender as *għaxxixlu*, sluggish, dawdling, formed from *għaxxes*, to lead a soft, idle life; Ar. عَشَّشَ, to nest (bird) + *lu*, *mexixlu*, glutton, formed from *mexix* (from *mexmex*, to gnaw or suck out a bone, Ar. مَشَّشَ, to extract the marrow of a bone, Hava) + *lu*. *Kaċiċlu*, if Semitic, might be formed by analogy from obsolete *kaċċeċ* (cp. Ar. كَجَّ, to play) + *lu* denoting with contempt the silly man that still delights in child's play, hence the imbecile. As for the change of Ar. ج to Maltese *ċ*, it will be remembered that in Maltese voiced consonants at the end of a word are unvoiced hence *kaċċ* for Ar. *kagg* whence *kaċċeċ* for *kaggeċ* by regressive assimilation.

Kafkaf, occurring in the phrase *ta' kafkaf*, riff-raff, the rabble. Not in the Maltese dictionaries though the word is well known in the spoken language. Cp. Ar. كَفْكَفَ 'repousser, éloigner quelqu'un, et l'empêcher d'aborder quelque chose', Kaz. To repel, to prevent a. o. from, (Hava) whence perhaps the M. phrase *ta' kafkaf* to indicate the sort of people one must keep at arm's length.

Kagħbur, m. n. Goats' and sheep's dried dung; cp. Ar. كُعْبُرَة 'fiente séchée à la queue du chameau,' Kaz.

Kagħbura, also *kagħba* (Munxar, Gozo), f. n. An old ugly woman; a hag. Not in the M. dictionaries. Cp. Ar. كَعْبَرَة, 'femme grosse et mal faite', Kaz.

Kagħweġ, int. v. To wriggle. Quadriliteral used in the 2nd form. See *Qagħweġ*.

Karfa, f. n. Chaff; derived by Barb. from Ar. كَرْفَأَ, to froth forth (pot), Hava. It occurs in N. Afr. Arabic. Cp. كرفة, 'residu de balles, débris d'épiste de paille après le vannage', Beauss. For the figurative meaning of *karfa*, the rabble, the mob, Fal. cp. كرفة النّاس, 'la lie du peuple', رجل كرفة, 'un homme de rien', Beauss., M. *raġel karfa*, a scoundrel.

Katusa, f. n. Drain pipe. For the origin cp. Ar. قادوس, trough of waterwheel, and Sic. *catusu* (whence our M. word), doccione di terra cotta

per condurre le acque. Cp. Gr. κάδος. The following note is very interesting: *'Catusu* non ha da fare con *catu* come penserebbe Traina, ma rispecchia l'arabo *kadus* derivato dall gr. *kados* condotto di acque da cui pur vengono lo spagnuolo *alcaduz* ed il portoghese *alcatruz* (SGT V. III P. 99)'. For the last two words, see also *Glossario Etimologico*, L. Equilayz Yanguas.

Kaxkar, tr. v. To drag anything on the ground, Fal. who gives also the meaning 'to sift too much', not given by Car. and which I myself have never heard. Not in Dess. Barb's far-fetched explanation is that it is 'forma verbale fabbricata in Oriente in tempo antico ed oggi in disuso e basata sulla voce persiana', خُشْكَار, bran mixed with flour, Hava. My explanation is that the M. word is a variant of Ar. كَشْكَشَ, to rustle (snake, cloth), Hava, made up of the doubled Ar. base كَشَّ, same meaning, the second base in Maltese being replaced by onomatopoeic *kar* in M. *karkar*, to drag. Whence M. *kaxkar* for the combination *kaxx + kar*. For the intransitive use of *kaxkar*, cp. *is-serp* (It. serpe) *jitkaxkar ma' l-art*, the snake drags itself on the ground.

Kerċaħ, tr. v. To benumb (with cold); *imkerċaħ bil-bard*, 'dithering with cold', also *mkerċaħ* generally, shivering with cold. Not in the M. dictionaries. Cp. Ar. كرشوحة, 'se dit de toute chose vieille et mauvaise, même d'une femme'. مكرشح, used adjectivally, has the same meaning, Beauss. *Kerċuħa* survives in the family nickname, *Ta' Kerċuħa* (Gozo).

Kmieni, adv. Early. Dubious etymology queried by Stumme M.S. Derived from Ar. كَمَنَ, to hide, by the late Dr. J. Micallef but his explanation is semantically and phonetically inadmissible. It is also derived perhaps from Ar. كَمَانَ, still, e.g. it is still early, or it might stand for كَمَا يَأْتِي by Dess. My suggestion is that this adverb is very likely a contraction from a possible vulgar Latin phrase *cum mane* or It. *con la mane*, with the morning, whence *kumma:ni*, ultimately *kmieni*, early, literally 'with the morning' by elision of the first syllable and the change of *a:* to *ie* by analogy with the إِمَالَة. Cp. Lat. phrase *a primo mane*, at the earliest dawn; *bene mane*, very early morning; *plane mane*, quite early in the morning. Cp. also *mani*, old ablative, the morning. In this sense, M. *kmieni* looks like a translation of its Semitic doublet *bikri* or *mal-bokra* from بَكَرَ, to rise up early in the morning, or *massebħ*, at dawn.

Kodux, with the stress on the 2nd syllable, occurring in the phrase *ma*

kodux li għandek is-sikkina tiegħi? 'You haven't got my knife by any chance?' Not in the M. dictionaries, but still current in Gozo. Possibly from obsolete *ikkoda*, Sic. *accadiri*, to happen + Maltese negative suffix *x*.

Kola, f. n. The ladybird. Dess. suspects a connection with the Middle Eastern كولة, the meaning of which is rather a hedge-hog. According to Barb. it is a contraction of It. *coccinella*. But, M. *kola* is short for *Nikola*. Cp. Sic. 'colacola vattini a la scuola' (Catania) with M. *Kola, kola tmur l-iskola*, (the ladybird, the ladybird, it goes to school) child's doggerel. Very interesting is the following note: 'Santo Nicola, asello (Noto), gallinetta della madonna (Palermo) vola vola Santa Nicola, invocazione palermitana della coccinella septem punctata. Raffigurata in San. Nicola la coccinella è protettrice dei bambini', (G. de Greg. SGI Vol. 8 p. 99).

Kukrumbajsa, f. n. A tumble head over heels, Fal. A sommersault. Not in Dess. According to Barb. it is a corruption of the Ar. phrase كَبْكَبَ بِالرَّأْس, 'capitombolare con la testa in giù'; but for a more likely origin cp. Ar. كربس, 'culbuter, renverser, تكربس, faire la culbute, تكربيسة Culbute, degringolade', Beauss. M. *kukrumbajsa* is a phonetically modified form of original diminutive *kurbajsa*.

L

Laħħ, int. v. To ask continually, to insist; to flash continually (lightning), whence *leħħa*, importunity, persistence, flash (of lightning), and *lħiħ*, importunate, petulant, Fal. For M. meaning cp. Ar. أَلَحَّ عَلَى, to harass with requests, أَلَحَّ فِي السُّؤَال, to beseech instantly, Hava. لاح, importunate, Wort. For closer M. meaning of first form, cp. لحّ, 'être avide, لحّة, avidité, envie de tout ce qu'on voit', Beauss. The Arabic word meaning 'to flash (lightning)' is the hollow verb لَاحَ, Hava, replaced in Maltese by the doubled verb *leħħ* which conveys the idea of insistence and continuity when referring to rain, another natural phenomenon that often accompanies lightning.

Laħwa! Brethren! Friends! Vocative expression. Note phonetic correspondence of M. *l* to *j*, *laħwa* standing for *ja aħwa* first explained by G. Vassallo in 'Il-Malti', Vol. II, 1926, pp. 49-50. Other such examples are *lew*, or, for *jew* Ar. أَوْ , and, occasionally, *lek*, if, for *jekk* (q.v.)

Lajma Lajma, adv. Slowly, leisurely. Usage shows that the M. adverbial phrase corresponds to Sic. *leime leime*, It. *lemme lemme*, very slowly; but for a possible association of sound and idea, cp. with Ar. لُؤْمَة , delay, تَلَوَّمَ , to linger, Hava.

Lanżit, m. n. Hog's, pig's bristles, bristles of a horse's tail. Not in Dess. Barb. gives rightly Sic. *la nzita*, la setola, appearing also as *nsita* 'il pelo che ha in sul filo della schiena il porco ed anche il pelo della coda dei cavalli', (Mort.). Seemingly a phonetic contraction of L. *lanositas*, It. lanosità, woolliness, hairiness.

Lawżar, m. n. A pedlar, hawker, Fal. Not in Dess. Barb suggests that the M. word is made up of أَلْ + وزَار , that is *'al + 'awżâr*, the latter, meaning 'burdens', being the plural of وِزْر . I suggest أَوْزَار is more likely the plural of وَزِير , 'celui qui est chargé d'un fardeau ou aide un autre à le porter', Kaz. But cp. also It. *lazzaro*, (Sic. *l'azzaru*) meaning 'straccione, briccone, villano, ineducato', Zing. For comparative semantics, note that M. *pastas*, originally 'a porter' from Sic. *vastasu*, portarore, facchino, Mort. is now generally used to indicate a vulgar person and it is an offence to call anybody *pastas*; so also 'facchino', which means both porter and a coarse person. No such social snobbery is implied in the corresponding English word.

Laxk, adj. Lax; loose; detached or detachable from its place; apt to shift (a screw, etc.); slack, relaxed, not tense or tight. Morally lax, wanton in speech. The extension of the idea of looseness from the physical sense to the moral one is a common semantic process of the human mind. Arabic has a phonetically similar word with a cognate meaning, لَشَا , to become vile, Hava, and لَشِىَ , 'tomber dans l'avilissement et dans le mépris, après avoir joui de considération et d'honneurs', Kaz. But cp. L. *laxicare*, frequentative of *laxare*, whence It. *lascare* 'allentare alquanto una corda', Zing., and Sic. *lasco* agg. (contrario di fitto e spesso), Mort. whence M. *laxk* and the verb *illaxka*, to grow loose; to become vile, to degenerate.

Lebleb, int. v. To desire ardently; to wave in the air (flag), Fal. Both Dess. and Barb. derive it from Ar. لَبْلَبَ , to fondle (her child, mother), to lick (her young, ewe), also to prate, Hava, whence M. *lablab*. Se-

mantically and also phonetically, the M. word links up with Ar. لَهِبَ, to blaze fiercely, with which cp. M. *in-nar ilebleb,* the fire blazes; to burn with thirst, with which cp. M. *imlebleb għal daqxejn ilma* with Ar. لَهَبَة, burning thirst; cp. M. *għandu lebba* (Monxar) *għall-logħob.* With Ar. لَهَبَان, burning heat, hot day, cp. M. *libien* (etymologically *libbien*) 'il tempo e l'anno in cui predomina la chiarezza e la serenità.' *Xitwa libiena,* 'quella parte dell'anno al principio di Novembre, nella quale ritorna periodicamente il bel tempo chiamato pure l'estate di San Martino *(is-sajf ta' San Martin)',* Car. The Ar. word corresponding to the M. adjectival form *libien* is لَهْبَان, burned by thirst, Hava. The phonetic process involved in the M. form is the reduction of a triradical base with medial *h* (ه) silent to a biradical one with phonetic shortening of the vocalic sequence to short *e,* then emphatic repetition of the base to stress the idea of intensity, whence ultimately the M. quadriliteral verb *lebleb.* Note that in *leblieba* in the sense of (1) plant name (bindweed) (2) ardent desire, we have two homophonous words that are historically different. In sense (1) it stands for Ar. لَبْلاب, bindweed, convolvulus, Hava. In sense (2) it links up with Ar. لَهِبَ.

Leġġ, m. adj. Lively, brisk (Monxar, Gozo) whence *leġġeġ* (also *laċċaċ*) *għajnejh,* 'his eyes brightened up', still heard at Msida, Malta, and perhaps elsewhere. Not in the M. dictionaries. The M. adj. derives from Sic. *leggiu,* adj. 'Snello, veloce, destro', Mort. For M. morphological similarity, with M. *leġġ* cp. also لَاجّ, pertinacious, from لَجَّ, to insist upon, Hava; and with *leġġeġ* cp. لَجَّجَ, 'allumer un feu violent; flamber, feu', Beauss.

Legleg, tr. v. To quiver (flesh); to jolt, to drink heavily. Dess. gives Ar. لَكْلَك, 'trotter', Dozy. For the M. meanings of Ar. لَغْلَغَ given by Barb., cp. 'nglouglou, bruit d'une liqueur versée dans une bouteille', Dozy; also 'agiter les mâchoires et tirer la langue (se dit d'un serpent); agiter quelque chose de manière qu'on en entende le bruit', Kaz. For comparative onomatopoeia, cp. M. *legleg* with Fr. *glouglou.* With *legleg,* to quiver (flesh), cp. رَجْرَجَ, to quiver (flesh), Hava, and for interchange of M. *l* and Ar. ر see *resaq.*

Letlet, int. v. To lap up, to drink by lapping, Fal. 'muovere la lingua (il serpente); bere (il cane, il gatto)' Car. This quadriliteral, as explained by Barb., is based on Ar. لَثَأَ, to lap (dog), Hava; and there is no connection with Ar. لَظْلَظ, to squirm (Frey.), لَتْلَتَ, to prate, and لَهِثَ,

to loll the tongue (dog), as suggested by Dess. who gives also تَلْتَلَثَ (II) without giving its meaning. Cp. تَلْتَلَثَ في, to waver in, Hava. But for the M. quadriliteral form which Barb. describes as a purely M. formation *(di fabbrica maltese)* cp. لَتَأَ, 'introduire la tête dans un vase et y boire en remuant la queue (se dit d'un chien)' Kaz. M. *letlet* results from the repetition of the first two radicals of Ar. لَتَأَ.

Lula, An invariable word. Woe, sorrow. *Lula għalikhom!* Woe to you! *Kulħadd b'xi lula,* 'everyone has some sorrow', Fal. Not in Dess. Barb.'s explanation that M. *lula* stands for Ar. لَوْلاَ, if not, is far-fetched. I suggest *lula* stands for Ar. *l* + *'awla* عَوْلَة, weeping, lamentation, (Hava) or *l* + *'awl* (عَوْل painful affair), Hava. For a similar use, cp. Ar. عَوْلَ فُلاَنٍ, woe to him. (M. *lula flien*) with the M. phrase given by Fal. *lula għalikhom,* woe to you! For coincidence of sound and meaning, note the interesting Latin word 'luella' or 'luela', an expiation, a punishment: *scelerisque luela carcer,* Lucr. 3, 1015 (Lewis and Short, Latin Dictionary).

M

Madar, coll. n. 'Gruppo di case', a group of houses. This interesting word is given by Car. only. No such collective form is found in Arabic. Cp. Bibl. Aram. מְדוֹר, dwelling-place, occurring in Daniel 4 22-29 (מְדָרֵךְ) and 521 (מְדוֹרָהּ). But I suspect the word is made up on the analogy of mimated collective nouns with the dubious good intention of increasing the M. vocabulary by increasing the number of derivatives from existing roots.

Madrab, m. n. A pilaster or doorway in the wall of a country house or farm-house, Fal. Cp. Ar. مِضْرَب, large tent, Hava. Cp. also مَضْرِب, 'lieu, endroit; place, emplacement, position', Beauss. Barb. thinks the M. word is Ar. دَرَّابَة and quotes the following from Dozy: 'Quand la porte d'une boutique est partagée en deux, dans le sens de la largeur, chacune de ces deux parties s'appelle دَرَّابَة'. But semantically this

is remote from the M. meaning. Dess. links it up with ضرب, to strike with a whip (M. *darab*), whence the Ar. form I have given, and with the less likely ظَرِبَ, to cleave, to stick to.

Malajr, adv. Soon, quickly, shortly. Dess. and Barb. following Stumme explain it as a composite, structurally mixed, made up of *ma'* (Ar. مع) + *ajru* (Sic. *airi*), literally 'with the wind', (Dess.: + Gr. ἀήρ). I suggest the M. adv. may link up with Ar. مُلَامِل, swift (ass), Hava. 'agile, rapide, véloce', Kaz. from Ar. لَمْلَمَ, to hurry on. In M., as in Ar., the liquid consonants interchange very frequently. The phonetic process involved in this case would be Ar. *mula:mil* > *mula:mir* > *mula(m)ir*, whence M. *malajr* with regular diphthongisation of *a* + *i*, the elision of *m*, and the change of *u* to *a* by regressive influence of the diphthong *aj*.

Mannas, tr. v. To tame from Rom. adj. *mans*, tame. It is obviously Sic. *ammanzari*, 'far mansueto' e *mansu* 'mansueto', Mort. from L. *mansus*, pp. of 'manere'. Dess., misled by an accidental phonetic similarity, links it up with Ar. مَأْنُوس, in which initial *m* is the preformative of the pp. of أَنِسَ, whence أَنَّسَ, to tame.

Matra, An exclamation. Dess. and Barb., following Fal., explain it as a composite word for *ma tara*, Ar. مَا تَرَى. The former gives also Ar. مَأْثَرَة, brilliant action, which in Maltese would become *ma:tra* or *mietra*, Ar. medial hamza in M. being changed to *a:* or *ie* (Cp. Ar. رَأْس, M. ra:s, Ar. يَأْس, M. jies). *Matra* entered into the vocabulary from the Sic. phrase '*Sciatera e matra!*', 'esclamazione di meraviglia per cosa strana e ripugnante', (Cf. Giac. de Greg., SGI Vol. 7).

Mbatt, m. n. A light breeze, Fal. Chopping sea. Not in Dess. According to Barb. it is Sic. *mi batti*, literally, it (the wind), strikes me. Though M. *mbatt* looks like a regular mimated formation from Ar. بَطَّ, 'frapper, battre', Beauss. (cp. M. *mqass*, scissors, from *qass*), the M. word is Sic. *mbatti* (Lat. imbattuere) 'pro Tropaei-orum; cioè venti di mare che soffiano sopra terra', given by Scobar, quoted by Giacomo de Gregorio, SGI. Vol. 7. Cp. also *mbattiti, mmattiti* 'in marineria dicesi ad una sorta di vento periodico in alcuni mari in tempo di estate, imbatto', Mort.

Meċlaq, int. v. To smack one's lips in eating, Fal. Not in Dess. According to Barb. it derives from Sic. *maciuddacchiàri o maciullacchiàri o*

masciullacchiàri, having the same meaning as in Maltese but unknown to Mort. *Meċlaq* is a mimated form from Ar. شَلَقَ, whence M. *ċellaq*, to smear butter on bread, etc.; dirty one's mouth with food (baby). For a similar formation cp. *maqdar*, to despise, mimated form of Ar. قَذَرَ, to loathe, to dislike; *masħar*, to ill-treat, vilify, from Ar. سَخِرَ, to scoff at. Cp. also Ar. *maxdaq* in مشدق باللسان, marmonner, Fagnan.

Mejt, m. n. Dizziness; orthographically with final *t* for historical *d* unvoiced at the end of a word; cp. Ar. مَيْد, Badger, Kaz. and Beauss. Verbal noun of مَادَ, to feel giddy, Hava, 'avoir le tournoiement de tête à la suite d'un voyage sur un bateau ou à la suite d'un excès de boisson', Kaz. No connection with Ar. مَيْت, dead (female), Hava, as explained by Barb.

Mekkaħ, tr. v. To spoil or dirty by use, Fal. Not in Dess. Barb. suggests Ar. مَحَقَ, to destroy, مَعَكَ (whence Maltese *miegħek*); finally It. *macchiare*. My suggestion is that it is a verbal mimated form of Ar. كَخّ, *caca*, Dozy. Cp. also كَخ, dirty (baby's talk), Spiro. For similar verbal formations see under *meċlaq*.

Mellaħ, tr. v. To salt, whence *tmellaħ* which, besides its literal meaning 'to be salted', means also 'to go to the dogs'; also figuratively, 'to die; to play the fool; to be nonchalant; not to care a hang'. In the rather vulgar idiom, *mur tmellaħ*, it means 'Go to Jericho!' Dess. and Barb. do not explain the figurative meaning of this verb. I suggest M. *tmellaħ* in this sense is denominative from Ar. مُلْحَة, witty saying. Kaz. gives also مَلْحَة, 'bon mot ou anecdote plaisante; facétie'. Cp. also مَلَّح, 'tromper', Fagnan.

Menża, f. n. A big stick carried in balance across the shoulders by one or more than one person with a heavy weight hanging on both sides. Given by Car. but not by Fal. Cp. Ar. مَنْسَاة, staff, stick, with *s* voiced in Maltese by the preceeding liquid.

Meslaħ, tr. v. To scatter (dirty water); to wipe off badly; to do one's work carelessly. Not in the M. dictionaries. This verb may be (i) formed by mimation from √SLH (cp. *maqdar, masħar*), or (ii) from √MSH, to wipe with *l* as an additional 4th radical, or (iii) it may be denominative from *mselħa* (Tunisian Ar. مِسْرَة), broom. I am inclined to accept (ii).

Mieġi, m. adj. Brackish; a word still in use in *ilma mieġi*, brackish water;

and in the place name *Ta' Bir Mieġi* at Żurrieq. Given by Car. only. Cp. Ar. مُوج, to be salt (sic), bitter, (Hava), formally adapted to a verb *tertiae radicalis infirmae* (cp. *ġieri*, current from *ġera*, to run, Ar. جَرَى) With the disappearance of the middle radical hamza, we should expect *mejjeġ*, not *mieġi*, from a consequent hollow verb M-[W]-Ġ. Cp. *kieħi* (for regular *kejjeb*, Ar. كَائِب), sorrowful, sad ('moestus, animi dolore pressus', (Vass.) from Ar. كَئِبَ, to be distressed, Hava.

Missier, m. n. Father. The common Semitic word for father is Ar. أَب. The M. word, the pl. of which is not *msiewer* but *misserijiet* (*missier* + *ijiet*) formed by the addition of a feminine suffix as in the case of most loan-words, has no connection with Ar. مُصَوِّر, as suggested by Dess. and by Roudanovski. M. *missier* is a composite loan word made up of Sic. *mio* + *sire*, 'my sire'. Cp. also Fr. *monsieur* (*Mon* + *sieur*). What is worth noting is that the M. word for mother is Semitic (*omm*), Ar. أُمّ. The Rom. name for father must have been borrowed by the natives from the Norman masters (1090) the ruling aristocracy who, as in England (1066), in time must have married native wives who stuck to the original language.

Moxx, m. n. Soft, tender, flabby, Fal. whence *moxxu*, slow, apathetic (person), from Sic. 'musciu, mezzo asciutto. Pigro, lento', Mort. But in the phrase *ġobon moxx*, in which it is used most, 'soft cheese', cp. also Ar. مِشّ, 'sorte de fromage qu'on tire du babeurre et du lait caillé', Dozy.

Mqareb, m. adj. Troublesome, naughty (person). For the M. meaning, cp. Ar. مُقارِب, 'mauvais', applied also to things in Sp. Ar. = شَيْءٌ مُقارِب, 'mala cosa', Pedro de Alcalà quoted by Dozy.

Mqieghta, f. n. Piece work. For M. meaning cp. N. Afr. Ar. مقاطع 'forfait, à forfait', Beauss.

Mramma, f. n. A strong, thick wall. The word is nearer to Sic. *muramma* (dialect of Caltagirone, It. *murame*), wall, as suggested by Barb. than to Ar. مَرَمَّة, 'cadre, châssis', Dozy; 'chambranle de porte, de croisée', Beauss, as explained by Dess.

Mtira, f. n. A furrow or any other sign marking the soil for sowing, thus ensuring that no part of it remains unsown; also the space between furrows; whence the diminutive form *mtajra*, any piece of land left fallow for some time, Car. Not in Dess. Barb. links it up with مُثِيرَة, unknown

in Ar. For the M. meaning, cp. N. Afr. مطيرة , 'petit morceau de terrain, carreau tracé pour labourer; Carreau, espace de terre carré planté de légumes', Beauss.

Muxa (also *moxa*) f. n. A heath, Fal. 'campo coperto di poca terra e in gran parte roccioso', Car. whence *muxi*, m. adj., wild rocky (plain), covered with very little soil. This form occurs in the place-name *Hal Muxi*. Barb. derives *muxa (moxa)* from Ar. مَشَى , to walk (M. *mexa*) and Dess. probably from مُوحُوشَة , (land) haunted by wild beasts, (Hava) which in Maltese would be either *imħawxa* or *mħuxa* with the *ħ* sound retained. The origin I propose is Ar. ماش , to form sand-beds, river, (Hava), whence مَوْش , alluvium, alluvious, alluvial deposits; 'detritus' (Salomé) such as one expects on a *moxa*, rocky land with eroded soil.

N

Najxu Najxu, adj. and adv. phrase. Tardy-tardily; sluggish-sluggishly. Not in the M. dictionaries though in current use. Ar. نَوُوش , which in Maltese would be *nawx* or *nux* with *najxu* as a possible diminutive with a Rom. ending (cp. *ħajdu* from *waħdu*), has the opposite meaning. Cp. رَجُل نَوُوش , a strong man (Hava) (but contrast Ar. يَأْس with M. jies, q.v.). For M. meaning note Heb. נוּשׁ , אָנַשׁ , 'aegrum esse'; Syriac ܢܫ , 'languivit, debilitatus est'; and Indo-Europ. νόσος; but the correspondence of Heb. ש to M. *x* is unusual, as in this respect M. agrees with Arabic, which has also نَأَش , to delay, (whence جَاءَ نَئِيشًا , he came very late), Hava, 'être remis, retardé, différé (se dit d'une affaire)', Kaz.

Naq, (obsolete) whence Vth form in M. *tnejjeq*, unrecorded in the M. dictionaries, with verbal noun *tinjiq*, squeamishness, said of a person who is hard to please; one who irritates you with his squeamishness. So we say *għandu ħafna tinjiq fl-ikel*. Considered vulgar because it is so like *tinjik* from *niek*, N. Afr. Ar. ناك . For the form and sense of Maltese *tinjiq*, cp. Ar. تَنَيَّق , 'être recherché dans sa mise et difficile

dans le choix des mets' (Kaz.) given as تَنَوَّق by Hava. For the change of Cl. Ar. و in hollow verbs with *j* as a 2nd radical in IInd forms cp. N. Afr. Ar. قَيَّم, and M. *qajjem* instead of Cl. Ar. قَوَّم.

Narra, occurring in imprecations with verbal oronominal suffixes (*narrani*, may I; *narrak*, may you; *narrah*, may he, or would he, etc.). Not in Dess. It is explained by Barb. as a composite word made up of عَرَا أَنْ, to befall (misfortune). But for a similar idiom, cp. N. Afr. Ar. من راه, 'puisse-t-il être, le voir,' من راك معلّق, 'puisses-tu être pendu', Beauss.; with which cp. the common Maltese imprecation *narrak mgħallaq*. In this sense, M. *narra* may be explained thus: *min rak* > *mirrak* > *nirrak*, varying according to the pronominal suffix used with the interchange of *m* and *r*. One hears also *larrak* for *narrak*.

Naska, f. n. Sense of smell (generally when speaking of dogs). Derived from Ar. نَشَق, a smell, (Frey.) whence *naskata*, a pinch of snuff, from نُشُوق, (Dozy) by Dess., as explained by Barb. M. *naska* is Sic. *nasca*, 'naso schiacchiato', Mort. an appropriate decsription of the nose of a dog trained for hunting. There is no instance of M. *s* corresponding to Ar. ش except M. *siġra*, Ar. شَجَرَة, and only one case of Ar. س corresponding to M. *x* (see *Għoxx*).

Neddu, a term of endearment applied to any domestic animal, a pet, (little dog, kitten, etc.), Fal. Not in Dess. Derived from Ar. نِدَاء, voice, call, (Hava) by Barb. The origin is doubtful. The word might perhaps link up with Ar. نَدَّ, to run away (camel), Hava. The noun pattern is Romance. Cp. *ballu*, ball; *Żeppu*, Joe (Joseph); *bellu*, nice.

Ngara, f. n. A nuisance; anything that causes inconvenience. In the XVth century *ngara* was also a form of tax. Derived from Ar. نُقْرَة, which has a different meaning, or نِقَار, dispute, quarrel, by Dess. and from نَغَارَة, unexplained and unrecorded in Arabic, by Barb., M. *ngara* is more likely a loan-word from Sic. *angaria*, It. *angheria* (molestia) from Greek ἀγγαρος, Zing.

Nibex, tr. v. To molest, to provoke, to tease, Ar. نَبَشَ, to dig up, exhume, Hava. For M. meaning, cp. نَبَشَ, 'chercher noise, taquiner', Beauss.

Noqba, f. n. Only Car. gives the word in the sense of 'a woman' or, as in the example given, *għadek daqxejn ta' noqba*, 'you are still a chit of a girl', in the sense of 'a young girl, a chit (with contempt)'. Cp. Ar. نُقْبَة,

a vest worn by women, Hava, and Heb. נְקֵבָה, a female, semantically linking up with نَقَبَ, to pierce; perforate.

Nxuri, m. adj. Tender. *Il-qoton għadu nxuri*, 'the cotton is not yet ripe', Fal. and Car. Unexplained by Dess. The adj. form نُشُورى, given by Barb. must be a Maltese transliteration, the only adj. form in the approximately M. sense given by Arabic dictionaries being نَاشِر, 'qui reverdit et se ranime à la suite d'une pluie', (Kaz.) from نَشَرَ, to become verdant after rain (land), Hava.

GH

Għad, adverbial particle with the meaning of Heb. עוֹד, still, yet. Like עוֹד in this sense, it takes the verbal pronominal suffixes (עוֹדֶנִּי, M. *għadni* for *għad* + *ni*, I still am, etc.) Cp. also use of عادِ as an indeclinable particle having the sense of إِنَّ in رَقَدْتُ وَعادِ أَبَاكَ سَاهِر, I slept while your father remained awake (Hava) which in M. might be translated *rqadt u missierek għadu* (*għad* + *u*, pron. suffix هُ) *jishar*. The particle *għad* is used indeclinably without pronominal suffixes when it precedes a verb in the Imperfect to indicate the future. In the Berber dialect of the Aites Segrouchets (Destaing), the particle *aḍ* (*ḍ* = ز) is also used with the verb in the aorist to express the future.

Għadira, f. n. A pool, lake, corresponding to غَدِير, pool left by the rain. In the dialect of Syria, it means also 'river', the meaning of the formally corresponding غَدِيرَة being 'lock, plait of hair', Hava. But for the distribution of the M. form and meaning, cp. N. Afr. غَدِيرَة, 'mare pour rouir le lin', and غَدِير, 'mare, flaque d'eau; bas-fond'; étang naturel', Beauss. With Ar. غَدِير, cp. M. *għadir* in place name *Font għadir* in Sliema. Malta has neither rivers nor large pools.

Għaġuża, f. n. An old woman. This word occurs in this sense only in the saying: *għalhekk l-għaġuża ma tridx tmut, għax aktar ma tikber aktar tkun taf*, literally, 'the reason why the old woman does not want to die is that the longer she lives the more she learns'. The corresponding

Arabic is عَجُوز , but for the M. form cp. عَجُوزَة , 'vieille femme; *mieux* عجوز ', Kaz., given also by Beauss. who records the expression عجوزة كبيرة , 'très vieille femme'.

Għakrux, m. n. pl. *egħkierex*. A snail. Not in Dess. Barb. suggests Berber أَغْرُوس or أَبْلَغْرُوس , which in M. would give *għarus* and *bal għarus* respectively and never *għakrux*. I suggest the M. word may link up with M. *għakrek*, to move very slowly, عكرك , to be lazy and slow, an Andalusian word given by Dozy, whence the adj. form *għakrux*, with final *x* for *k* meaning 'that goes very slowly'. It may also link up with N. Afr. تعكرش , 's'enrouler sur elle, corde', possibly suggesting the shape of the snail's shell, and عكروش , pl. عكارش , 'bouquin, lapin mâle', Beauss. For semantics, cp. possible origin of M. *gremxul* 'lizards' from Sic. *gramusciu*, rabbit. Very often names of animals and trees indicate a different species of trees or animals when transferred from one language to another.

Għala, Why; the reason. *Għala mort?* 'Why have you gone'? *Irrid naf l-għala*, 'I want to know the reason'. Cp. علاه , adv. 'pourquoi?, de quoi?' used in Arabia, Beauss. Cp. also Ar. عِلَّة , cause, and Syriac ܥܠܐ cause.

Għanċeċ, int. v. To glisten (plant wet with dew); to abound, Fal. According to Car., who does not give the latter meaning, this word is used for plants newly bursting from the soil, still tender and wet, shining in the sun. Not in Dess. Barb., going by meaning alone but not by phonetics, gives شَعْشَع , to shine. I suggest تعنكش from √ عنكش 'grimper', Beauss., the original meaning of *għanċeċ* being 'to climb, to creep up', applied to new plants climbing out of the soil. The idea of shining in the sun is a local extension of the original meaning. With عنكش , Beauss., cp. عَكِش , to be intermingled (herbs), Hava. The phonetic process involved would be the following: *għankax* > *għankaċ* > *għanċaċ* (or *għanċeċ*) with *k* changed to *ċ* by regressive assimilation of the second consonant in the second base. With the change of Ar. ش to *ċ* in Maltese, cp. *ċanfar*, to scold, Ar. شَنَف .

Għandur, m. adj. Severe, taciturn. A fop; coxcomb, Fal. But Car. does not give the first two meanings. Dess. writes 'عَنْدُور , Dozy, cp. Aram. with initial G, possibly cp. Perso-Siculan جان دار '. With عَنْدُور as

described by Dozy, for M. usage cp. غَنْدور pl. غَنادِرَة, fop, coxcomb, dandy, whence تَغَنْدَرَ, to be over-affected in dress, Hava and Elias. Dozy in his 'Dictionnaire Détaillé des Noms de Vêtements Arabes' (Amsterdam, 1845) on page 98 note 6, gives the following explanation: غُنْدور, 'en Espagne et au Magreb le mot signifiait "vaillant". Mais en Espagne désignait aussi "un rebelle" ou "un brigand", et le terme غُنْدُرَة, "un bande de mutins ou de brigands"'. In the Egyptian dialect, according to Burckhardt, غُنْدُرَة means 'high gaiety, fashion'.

Għargħax (more frequently **Għarrax**), tr. v. To tickle. Dess. gives أَرْعَش, to cause to shudder, Hava, but Arabic IVth form with medial radical *għ* formally corresponds to M. IIIrd form *riegħex*, medial radical *għ* being incapable or reduplication. Barb. gives obsolete Persian Ar. غَلْغَلَج, to tickle. I suggest that M. *għarrax* may be denominative from عُرْش, 'side of the neck; ear', particularly sensitive to tickling. Cp. *għannaq* 'to embrace' denominative from عُنُق, neck. It may also link up with خُرْخُش 'gratter, souris', Beauss.

Għarrieda, occurring in the adverbial phrase *għal għarrieda*, 'all of a sudden; unexpectedly'. Stumme suggests عَلَى غَيْرِ إِرَادَة, to which Dess. adds عَارِضِيّ (sic), and عَرَضِيَّة from عَرَض, to happen (accident). *Għal għarrieda* looks like a composite word made up of *għala* (عَلَى) + *il* (*ir* by assimilation of *l* with initial *r* of the following word) + *rieda* (إِرَادَة), literally 'at will, when one wants to', hence 'unpremeditatedly, unexpectedly'. Thus *gie għal għarrieda* literally would convey the idea that 'some one came when he wanted to and not when he was wanted'. But M. *għarrieda* may also derive from Ar. عَرَض, 'saisir quelqu'un, le prendre tout à coup (se dit de l'accès d'une maladie, etc.), mourir subitement', Kaz. In this sense, cp. M. *miet għal għarrieda*, 'he died suddenly'.

Għat, tr. v. To feed, used also in the VIIth form in *ingħat*, to take one's fill (of food), whence *għatwa*, refreshments; etymologically final *t* stands for unvoiced *d*. Cp. غَذَا, to feed, from which it is correctly derived by Barb. while Dess. mistakes it for غاث, to assist, Hava.

Għoxx, m. n. (1) nest; (2) '*mulieris pudenda*'. These meanings link up with two different Ar. words which in Maltese have merged into one form. With the first meaning, cp. Ar. عُشّ, bird-nest upon a tree (whence M.

denominative verb *għaxxex*, to lie snugly in bed, to lead a soft or easy life); with the second meaning, cp. Ar. عُسّ , 'vulve, parties naturelles de la femme', Beauss.; 'verge, pénis', Kaz. Vass. gives *għoss*, now obsolete, in the sense of 'pudenda postica, culus, anus'.

Għuxa, This obsolete word occurs in the church name *San Ġwann ta' Għuxa*, church of St. John the Almoner. The nearest phonetic suggestion is Heb. עזר , to lend aid, to come to help, linking up with Ar. غَاثَ , to succour, whence إغَاثَة an asylum, as explained by Pedro de Alcala '*lugar donde huimos*'.

O

O, conj. Or. *O int o ħuk*, 'either you or your brother', for *jew* أَو , possibly influenced by It. *o* or. But for a similar phonetic development, cp. also Heb. אֹ , or, and for the change of Ar. *aw.* to M. *u* and Heb. *o* respectively, cp. يَوْم , M. *jum*, Heb. יוֹם .

Obda, tr. v. To obey; pp. *obdut, obbidjenza*, obedience (*disubbidjenza*, disobedience) from Sic. *obbediri*, Lat. *obedire*. Both Barb. and Dess. link up the M. verb, quite unnecessarily, with Ar. عَبَدَ , to worship, serve (God), Hava.

P

Paħpaħ (variant of *baħbaħ*), int. v. To speak with difficulty or in a stifled voice, Fal. In this sense cp. Ar. بَخبَخ , to snore, Hava. The other sense, 'to cook or boil to a jelly', Fal., is a derived meaning of *tpaħpaħ* (Vth Form), 'to be hollow, not compact; to lose consistency; to swell out, grow unhealthily fat (flesh)' with which cp. Ar. تَبَخبَخ , 's'étendre nonchalamment', whence *mpaħpaħ*, swollen out, unhealthily fat, with which cp. also مُبَخبَخ , 'étendu nonchalamment; bouffi, bien

portant (petit enfant)', Beauss. With *tpaħpaħ*, variant of *tbaħbaħ*, to take a bath, enjoy throwing water on oneself, etc., cp. Ar. بَخْبَخ, to cool (heat), Hava, 'Tremper du pain dans du lait', Beauss. This word has no connection with Sic. *pappari* as suggested by Barb. Dess. omits it.

Paspar, tr. v. To invent stories, to tell fibs, Car.; whence *paspura* (also *praspura*, Fal.), pl. *praspar*, not in Car. and Dess., a fib, some strange action or intrigue. Fal. explains it in the less common sense of 'a portion, a selection of various articles'. The origin of the word might be Ar. بَصَّرَ, (> *passar* > *paspar*), to make one understand, Hava, whence M. *basar* (also *pasar*), to guess.

Paxpax, int. v. Used in the 2nd form in the sense of 'to swell out' (flesh) to grow unhealthily fat, a synonym of *tpaħpaħ* (q. v.). Not included in the M. dictionaries. Cp. Ar. تَبَجْبَجَ, to be fat, to be swollen, Hava.

Q

Qada, f. n. Sentence, judgement, decree; fate; destiny, Fal. Cp. Ar. قَضِيَّ or قَضَاءُ, sentence, judgment, fate, from قَضَى, to judge, to fulfil (a duty); to satisfy (a want), Hava. Whence the M. verb *qeda*, to serve, to satisfy (a need). Car., the only Maltese lexicographer that lists his words by radicals, gives *qada* separately and not under *qeda*, as if the radicals were different. Car. wrongly gives *taqdir*, contempt, v. n. of *qadar* (obsolete), Ar. قَذِرَ, to loathe, under *qada*.

Qaħqaħ, int. v. To cough (smoker's cough). Cp. Syrian Ar. قَحَّ, to cough, Hava. N. Afr. قحقح, 'rire aux éclats'. Beauss. The same meaning is recorded by Spiro and Dozy. But for a meaning nearer to Maltese cp. قَحْقُوحَ, 'toux', Beauss.

Qajjar, tr. v. To dry partially (washed linen, etc.), Fal. I have heard it used in the Vth form as a synonym of *tqaxlef*, to get dry; *il-ġobon jitqajjar*, '(fresh) cheese gets dry', and the pp. *mqajjar*, in the sense of *merfugħ fuq riġlejh*, 'standing (raised) high on its feet (ox).' The M. meaning of dryness might be derived from Ar. قَيَّرَ, to tar (a camel, a ship), Hava, 'cirer, enduire de cire', in Sp. Ar. (Dozy), and more closely, as

suggested by Barb., from Berber *aqqâr* 'secher' (See p. 26 of his book 'La Langue Berbère: morphologie', Paris 1929). Dess. thinks it may stand for **ajjar*, to air, semiticised denominative verb from *ajru*, air, Sic. *ajru*.

Qajla, adv. Slowly, gently, softly, Fal. Little by little, as in *qajla qajla* (or *bil-qajla l-qajla*), *timtela l-ġrajra*, 'many a little fills the jar'; also 'seldom, rarely', though this meaning is not given by Car, and Fal. For ex. *Qajla kont tiġi*, 'you would hardly come', with which cp. قَلَّة مَا جِئْتَ. With *qajla qajla*, cp. Ar. قَلِيلاً قَلِيلاً, little by little (Hava). Car. gives this word under *qal, iqil*, to put oneself in the shade to sleep, Fal. (Ar. قَالَ (i) whence Vth form تَقَيَّلَ, to take a nap and M. *maqjel*, ox stall, pen for sheep, Ar. مَقِيل, resting place) but the M. word etymologically should be listed under *qliel*, (q. v.).

Qajż, exclamation. A word with which to call pigs. *Qajżu*, a small pig (child's word), Fal. This is a shortened form of the diminutive of *qażquż* (q. v.), that is *qżajqaż* > *qżajż* > *qajż*. The *u* in *qajżu* is a Romance suffix by analogy with such loan-words as *papru*, gander; *qabru*, crab; etc. According to Barb. *qajż* is an apocopation of Ar. قَذِر, dirty, and *qajżu*, an apocopation of قاذورة, dirt. This explanation is semantically far-fetched and phonetically inadmissible. Dess. does not include it.

Qalil, m. adj. Severe, fierce. See *qliel*.

Qamqam, int. v. Occurring in a doggerel in one of our ancient folk tales:-

ixtri l-qamqama wil-qamqam
U xejn la tfittex kemm qam,

'Buy the cow and the ox, and do not worry about the price'. Not in the M. dictionaries. Cp. غَمْغَمَ, to bellow (bulls); and غَمْغَمَة, bellowing

Qanċeċ, int. v. To be thrifty, to practise severe economy either because of stinginess or necessity. Barb. suggests قَشَّشَ, to pick up, (meaning of Ist form). Dess. suggests قَشَّاق, a belt (Dozy), in which the money was kept. I suggest قَمَّشَ, to pick up refuse (whence the M. idea 'not to waste anything, to save even refuse'), the phonetic process involved being Arabic *qamax* > *qamxax* > *qanxax* > *qanċaċ (qanċeċ)*. For the development of a quadriliteral verb from a triliteral one, cp. M. *gerbeb*, to roll, with Ar. كَرَبَ, to twist, (Hava) and for change of Ar. ش to Maltese *ċ (ċ)*, cp. Syr. Ar. شَلَحَ, to throw off (Hava), M. *ċewlaħ* (also *xewlaħ*).

Qannic, m. n. A hurdle made of reeds on which fresh cheese-cakes are dried. This is Sic. *cannizzu*, denoting the same thing, but used also for the drying of fruits, in this sense agreeing with N. Afr. Ar. كَنِيج pl. كنانج, 'claie pour faire sécher les fruits', Beauss. Like its Maltese equivalent, the N. Afr. noun is a loanword from the same source.

Qagħweġ (also *qagħwex*), int. v. To writhe, to roll one's self up. Barb. derives it from Ar. كَاشَ, to be active, which, apart from having a different meaning, is morphologically a hollow verb which never corresponds to a quadriliteral in Maltese. Dess. gives كَعْكَشَ, to wriggle, on the authority of two Tunisian native teachers (Beauss. gives كَعْكُوش, 'tortu homme, arbre'). But cp. قَعْشَ, to fold (Hava), whence M. *tqagħwex* literally 'to fold one's self (writhe).' For an example of Arabic triliteral corresponding to Maltese quadriliteral, cp. Ar. خَتَلَ with M. *ħawtel*, q. v., and Ar. شَلَحَ with M. *ċewlaħ* (q. v.)

Qarabocca, f. n. (collective, *qaraboċċ*). Millet. The word looks like a composite formation made up of *qara* (Ar. قَرْعَة, pumpkin) +*boċċa* (Sic. *boccia*) from the roundness of its shape and its likeness to a diminutive pumpkin. Not in Dess. Barb's explanation that it is a corruption of Persian Ar. جَاوَرْس is phonetically inadmissible.

Qarweż, tr. v. To cut, crop (the hair); explained as a verbal noun from كَرَوَّس, big-headed, by Barb., and derived from قَرْوَط, to nibble, by Dess. though M. *ż* never corresponds to Ar. ط. This word is likely a quadriliteral development with و as an additional radical of قَرَضَ, 'couper, retrancher en coupant', Kaz. Cp. M. *ħawtel* from خَتَلَ, and for correspondence of Ar. ص to M. *ż*, see under *qażquż*. Cp. also Sic. *carusari*, 'tondere, tosare, e dicesi propriamente de' piedi de' cavalli e simili', Mort. Though the Sicilian verb has been suggested as the origin of the M. verb, I am inclined to adopt the Arabic origin.

Qaxlef, tr. v. To dry up. Barb. gives قَشَّفَ, to suffer privations, whence the derived idea of getting dried. The IInd form occurs in قَشَّفَ عِيشَة, to render life hard (God). More convincingly Dess. links it up with *ħoxlief*, hay; dry grass, with which cp. مُحَشْلَف (M. *mħaxlef*), 'deséché', Fag., and حُشْلَاف, كُشْلَاف Stumme M.S. p. 121; but cp. also N. Afr. شقلف, 'racornir; se boursoufler, se soulever en écailles'; تشقلف

(M. *tqaxlef*), 'se racornir', مشقلف (M. *mqaxlef*), 'racorni', whence very likely M. *qaxlef* by metathesis of the first two radicals.

Qażqaż, int. v. To grunt. See *Qażquż*.

Qażquż, m. n. (pl. qżieqeż) pig. An onomatopoeic formation from N. Afr. Ar. قَرْقَزَ, 'crier, faire du bruit', Beauss., whence M. *qażqaż*, to grunt. Cp. also قُصَاقِص, strong and big (lion, camel) Hava.; قَصْقَصَ; 'appeler à soi un chien' (Kaz.) and for the change of Ar. ص to *z* in M., cp. M. *żaba'*, to paint, from Ar. صَبَغَ. Barb. thinks the M. word is the iteration of the Turkish خُوك, with *ż* in Maltese for ك. Not in Dess.

Qbiela, f. n. Rent. Cp. Ar. قَبَالَة, obligation assumed, Hava. But for a definition nearly corresponding to that in the Maltese Civil Law, cp. 'contrat par lequel on permet à quelqu'un d'exploiter une terre, moyennant une taxe, une redevance, que le dernier s'engage à payer annuellement en argent ou en nature,' Dozy.

Qell (also **Qliel**, IXth form not given in the M. dictionaries), int. v. To become ferocious, cruel. Cp. أَقَلَّ, to seize (fear), Hava, 'corripuit aliquem, tremor', Frey., whence the derived M. meaning 'to grow ferocious'; and إِسْتَقَلَّ, to grow angry, Hava. For a M. Ist verbal form corresponding to the Xth Ar. form in meaning, see under *ħalliel*, a thief. The meaning of Ar. قَلَّ being 'to be rare, small', the meanings of *qilla*, ferocity, cruelty, and of *qalil*, ferocious, cruel, are purely local, as is the meaning of *qell*. But with M. *qilla*, cp. قِلَّة, 'tremor, palpitatio ex ira aut desiderio', Frey., the M. meaning denoting the cause for the effect.

Qellux given by Car. only for *Gellux* (q. v.)

Qerqni, m. n. An ugly dwarf, pigmy, Fal. Perhaps connected with N. Afr. Ar. قرقر, whence مقرقر or أمّ قرقر, 'crapaud', Beauss., M. *qerqni* being a different adjectival form standing in this sense for *qerqri*. Barb. suggests a hypothetical M. form قَرْقَمِيّ, *qarqmi*, from قَرْقَمَ, to ill feed (a child), Hava. Dess. writes: 'In Tunis it was suggested to me that this adjective originally stood for قَرْقَنِيّ, a native of the isles called Kerkenneh'.

Qliel, IXth form. Not in M. dictionaries. See *Qell*.

Qoċċata, f. n. Top (of head, tree, etc.); summit, whence *qaċċat* tr. v. To cut off the top, or merely, to cut off; intransitively, to rise high up (summit of hills, top of trees, etc.). Dess. gives قَشَطَ for *qaċċat*, and

for *qoċċata,* perhaps قشطة (cream [that goes to the top]). Barb. gives Sic. *cuzzata* < *cozzo.* Not in Mort. I suggest the M. word may be formed of It. *coccia* (dialectal), head (Zing.) + suffix *ata* (cp. xemx*ata,* sunstroke), with *qaċċat* as a denominative verb.

Qorr, m. n. Frog. Given by Car. only. Cp. Ar. قُرَّة , frog, Hava. M. *qorr* and *qirra* (intense cold) should be given under the same radicals. *Ta' Qorru* is a family nickname.

Qrempuċ (also *qrenpuċ*) m. n. A kind of trefoil. Beauss. gives قرنونش and قرنينوش , s. m. 'cresson, cresson de fontaine; sisymbre', and Dess. gives Ar. قَرَانْبُوش (a name of some similar plant) given on the authority of two native Tunisian teachers. Barb's explanation that the M. word is a corruption of حَمَام الْبُرْج is phonetically absurd.

Quċċied, coll. n. Newly hatched lice, the Maltese for 'nits' given by Dess. being *subien* (q. v.). According to Dess. 'it might stand for 'daughter of the belt', (Ar. قِشَاط = belt)'; Ar. قَشَّاط has also the meaning of 'pirate'. Barb. derives it from the Sic., *cucciddu* or *cuccieddu,* diminutive of *coccìu* or *cuocciu,* 'grano, granellino'. Both explanations are wrong. The M. word is matched in N. Afr. Ar. كَشَّار , 'pous qui viennent d'éclore', Beauss. from Ar. كَشَدَ , to cut with the teeth, Hava.

R

Radda, f. n. Black silk edging on a woman's scarf or mantle; *radda talmoħriet,* 'furrow', Fal. Cp. Ar. *mradd,* pl. *mraddât* meaning 'bordure en relief, rebord', Bart., whence the Maltese meaning 'furrow'. Cp. also رَدْهَة , pl. رُدَّه , hollow in a stony ground, (Hava). M. *radda* may also link up with Ar. رَدَّة , a return, or رَدَّدَ , to repeat, the 'furrow' resulting from a return of the plough to and from the same place. According to Dess. it is perhaps ردا , a mantle.

Raħal, int. v. To set off, Fal. with which cp. Ar. رَحَلَ, to depart, (Hava). Fal gives also *rħie-la* (grammatical orthography *rħielha*), he set off, under √R-Ħ-L from which we should expect *raħalha* as in *telqilha għan-Nadur,* 'he set off to Nadur', from *telaq,* to set off. *Rħiela* is made up

of *reħa* (to let go) + *l* (indefinite indirect object) + *ha* (fem. pronominal suffix). With *reħa* surviving in Maltese in the sense of 'to loose, to let go', cp. Ar. أَرْخَى, to run swiftly, and أَرْخَاهُ وَلِ, to loose the reins to (a camel), Hava. The origin and meaning of *lha* in *rħielha* are due to Italian influence. Cp. It. *svignarsela, godersela,* with which cp. also the use of English 'it' as indefinite object of transitive and intransitive verbs in 'face *it* out', 'lord *it* over him', 'have done *it*' (M. *għamiltha*) etc.

For local meaning of M. *raħal,* village, cp. Ar. رَحْل, dwelling, stage, each of the villages in Malta having started originally as a sort of stage in the wandering of the immigrant inhabitants. For shortening of *raħal* to *ħal,* cp. M. *ħam* (ħa:m) and *ħa:ma* (ħa:ma) shortened in some villages of Gozo from *irħam,* marble > Ar. رُخَام, and *irħama,* a piece of marble, Ar. رُخَامِي, respectively. This interesting abridgement of *raħal* appears before most village names in Malta but not in Gozo. By phonetic analogy of the assimilation of the article to any of the following so called 'sun-letters', final *l* of *ħal* sometimes assimilates with the initial 'sun' consonant of the village name as: *ħaż-Żabbar* for *Ħal Żabbar.* With M. *raħħal* (*raħ'ħa:l*), shepherd or goatherd, cp. Ar. رَحَّال, 'chamelier', رَحَّالَة, (cp. M. *raħħala*) 'bédouins'. With M. *merħla,* flock of sheep or goats, cp. Ar. مَرْحَلَة, 'est *mandra,* dans l'ancienne traduction latine d'une charte sicilienne apud Lello (Amari)', Dozy. In both Beauss. and Hava, مَرْحَلَة means only 'a day's journey'.

Rbus, m. n. An iron punch, a puncheon, Fal. Barb. gives the phonetically acceptable Sic. 'ripússa'. Not in Mort. in the M. sense, but cp. Ar. رَبَسَ, he struck, slapped, Salomé; and, perhaps رابُوز, 'soufflet, instrument pour souffler', Dozy. If the radicals are √R-B-Ż, final *s* is explainable as unvoiced *ż* in final position.

Resaq, int. v. To approach, Fal. Equated with رسخ, to bring to a standstill (Dozy) by Stumme M.S. p. 109, and considered a variant of the passive رُزِقَ, to receive, by Dess.; this word is better explained by Barb. as a variant of Ar. لَصِقَ, to stick, to glue to, Hava. Dess.'s suggestion that M. *resaq* stands for passive رُزِقَ is unacceptable because by analogy with the few surviving M. passive forms we should expect *rożoq* (cp. *ħoloq,* passive of *ħalaq,* Ar. خَلَقَ, to create). With

M. *resaq* cp. also Ar. رَصَعَ , to stick, to adhere to, Hava, (variant of لَصِقَ), 'porter un coup de lance au point d'en faire entrer le fer dans le corps', Kaz., whence the M. meaning 'to get near, to approach'. With M. *ressaq*, to bring together, to bring near, cp. رَصَّعَ 'appliquer, adapter, ajuster, joindre l'un à l'autre; ranger, arranger', Kaz.

Rewwixta, f. n. An affray; an uproar. According to Dess. cp. يوريش , perhaps وَرَّشَ (IInd Form), to stir up the people. Barb. transliterates غَوْشَة without bothering to explain the unusual change of Arabic غ to *r* in Maltese. I derive *rewwixta* from It. *rovista(re)*, whence *rovistio* 'suono di cose sonore frugate', Zing. The phonetic process is *rovista* > *rovixta* > *rowixta* > *rowwixta* > *rewwixta*. The phonetic lengthening of a semi-vowel in inter-vocalic position is common in Maltese.

Rexaq, tr. v. To strike off excess at top of a grain measure. Dess. gives رِشْقَة , a reed (really an arrow), for M. *rexqa*, the rod used for the purpose. The correct explanation is given by Barb., who derives *rexaq* from Sic. *rascari* 'levar la superficie di chicchesia con ferro o altra cosa tagliente', Mort. For frequent change of Romance *s* to *x* in M., cp. It *scopa* with M. *xkupa*, broom, and for change of Romance *k* sound to M. *q*, cp. Sic. *corte* and M. *qorti*, court.

Rieq, m. n. Spittle. This word is not the pl. of riq, ريق , as Barb. explains, but a phonetic rendering of *ri:q* (a pronunciation that is met with in some of the dialects), Ar. ريق , saliva. So in written M. we come across phonetic *trieq*, street, for etymological *trîq*, a form still current in some villages. With *rejjaq*, to feed and *trejjaq*, to eat, to take some food especially on an empty stomach, to breakfast, cp. *reioq*, 'déjeûner le matin pour la première fois; dans ce sens, ce verbe semble un dénominatif de *'al-errîq* (على الريق [= M. għar-rieq]) 'à jeun', Març. 315. Cp. also رَيَّقَ 'humecter avec sa salive', Barth. which links up with the custom of the peasant Maltese mothers of putting food into the mouths of their babes wetted with their saliva, and تريّق *trayyaq*, 'déjeûner le matin', Barth.; he broke his fast, breakfasted, Salomé.

Rita, f. n. Membrane, film, Fal. Cp. رِيطَة , 'pellicule; Pellicule de l'oeuf sous la coque; Pellicule entre les écailles de l'oignon', Beauss. (Cp. M. *rita tal-bajd, rita tal-basal*). Barb. thinks it stands for غِطَاء , with the unusual correspondence of Ar. غ to M. *r*. Cp. also his note on *rewwixta* (q. v.).

Rixtellu, m. n. A rail, gate; flax comb, Fal. Obviously from Sic. *rastèllu*, as explained by Barb., and not from Persian رشتن, to twist, to spin, as suspected by Dess. in connection with *rextel*, to card, to grate, which is a denominative verb from *rixtellu*.

S

Sa, adv. Until, as far as. As Dess. points out, some look upon this particle as a shortening of *sejjer*, سَائِر, (Stumme), others as صار; some think it a local use of the *s* of the future. De Sacy suspected it to be a corruption of حَتَّى, which is rather borne out by Vassalli's variant *ħasa*, e.g. *ħasabiex;* in *sal-art*, 'face to the ground', the Arabic equivalent is obviously إِلَى الأَرْض. In the phrase *sas-sa*, 'till now', the first *sa* is this particle, the second is the noun سَاعَة. While there is no doubt that *sa* prefixed to the imperfect of a verb, to indicate the future, is Ar. سَـ (cp. سَأُسَافِر, *sa nsiefer*, 'I will depart'), the etymology of M. *sa* in the sense of 'as far as, until' is dubious. De Sacy's suggestion that it stands for حَتَّى presupposes the unusual change of Ar. ت to M. *s*. In support of De Sacy's suggestion, it is worth noting that in the dialect of Syria حَتَّى is shortened into *ta*, but there is no instance of Ar. dental *t* (ت) being changed into the dental fricative *s*, unless this is the solitary example of such change. There is one example of Ar. voiceless dental fricative *th* (ث) changed to *s* in Maltese: M. *silġ*, snow, Ar. ثَلْج. I am inclined to look upon *sa* as a shortening of It. *sino a*, until, as far as, the phonetic process being *s(ino) + a > sa*. Maltese has other similar particles from It., such as *dment* or *drament*, whilst, as long as, from It. *di mentre*. Maltese has also *ser* (to be distinguished from the particle *sa*), a shortening of *sejjer*, سَائِر, as *ser nitkellem*, a loan translation of the use of It. *andare*. Cp. also the use of 'go' in 'I am going to speak'. The composite phrases *sakemm*, 'until'; *sabiex*, 'in order to'; *sassa*, 'up to now, hitherto' are loan-formations (literal translations) of It. *finquanto, finchè, finora* respectively.

Safa, int. v. To become; to be reduced to a state of (poverty, etc.) This verb is incorrectly spelt with final *għ* by Car. and Fal. who follow Vass. and considered a puzzling word by Dess. while Barb. links it up with سَفَعَ, which has quite a different meaning. For the M. meaning, cp. N. Afr. Ar. صَفى, 'être terminée, consommée, affaire; parvenir, arriver à', Beauss. Thus, M. *l-irġiel sfaw midruba,* etc., 'the men have "become" wounded', literally: the men ended by getting wounded, or the affair ended by the men getting wounded; so also: *safa fqir,* 'he became poor', literally: he ended by becoming poor.

Sar, int. v. For the M. meaning of the 2nd form, *sajjar,* to cook, to ripen, cp. Ar. صَيَّر, 'mettre des poissons ou des fruits *en saumure*', Dozy, seemingly a denominative verb of صير, little salt-fishes, Hava.

Sarwal, tr. v. To embroil; to entangle; also to tell lies. Cp. تَسَرْوَل, to put on the 'sarwal'. Perhaps the M. word is a lingering indication of the low esteem in which the Christian wearers of *qalziet* (trousers), a word of R. origin from It. *calsetta,* held the Islamic wearers of the سِرْوَال. A memory of racial antagonism is retained in the imprecation, now mild because meaningless to the non-Maltese, *reħ dinek,* for *aħraq dinek,* 'burn (or cursed be) your faith'. See *din.*

Sebt, m. n. Reed, wand, sceptre, Car. Not in Fal. Unexplained by Barb. Derived from سِبْط by Dess. For M. meaning, cp. Ar. سِبْط, Heb. שֵׁבֶט, sceptre, P. de Alcalà (Dozy).

Seksek, int. v. To gossip about other people, to try to find out what they are doing; given as a variant of *seksef* by Fal., and explained also as a phonetic variant of M. *sefsef,* to whisper in the ear, Ar. سَفْسَف (Dozy), by Dess. Barb. gives it as a corruption of *seksef* (to spy) with final *f* for *k*, the phonetics possibly influenced by the semantics of *sefsef,* to spy out. With *seksef,* cp. Ar. سَكْسَك 's'humilier, s'abaisser, se soumettre', Kaz., 's'humilier devant quelqu'un pour obtenir quelque chose', Barth.

Sibien (also *subien*) coll. n. Nits. Not to be mixed up with *subien,* male children, Ar. صُبْيَان, pl. of young man, Ar. صَبِيّ. Not in Fal., Dess. and Barb. For M. meaning, cp. صيبانة ,صيبان, Beauss., *sibien,* Barth., 'lentes', under صيب, (M. *subien, subiena*). The word is also given by Badger.

Sittma (also *siddma,* Fal.) f. n. Forehead. Dess. gives أَسْطَمَة, (the

best part), Barb. gives صَدْمَة , literally 'a blow, a collision'. But for the M. meaning, cp. Ar. صَدَمَة , 'calvitie', and the dual صَدْمَتَانِ or صِدْمَتَانِ , 'les deux côtés du front', Kaz.

Sodda, f. n. Bed. Unknown to Egyptian; it occurs in Sp. Ar. and N. Afr. Ar. For the original meaning, the following description is interesting: سدّة , 'Plancher large de 2 mètres, à 1 m, 50 du sol, placé au fond du côté des chambres mauresques qui sont longues et étroites. Ce plancher, caché par un rideau sert de lit', Beauss. 'Lit de repos, canapé', Dozy; 'operticulum', Schiapparelli.

Stalla, int. v. To stop; to stop short; to wait, mainly used in Birgu with pp. *stallat*. Cp. It. *stallarsi*, to carry, to loiter and Sic. *stallari*, 'situare in un posto opportuno durevolmente', Mort., the reflexive meaning of which agrees with the M. sense. It has nothing to do with Ar. أَلَّا (10th Form) as explained by Sutcliffe (p. 135) and by Dess.

Stwiel, m. n. A large beam. Not in Dess. A loan. word < It. *stollo* < Ll. *hastula*. With the M. expression *twil qisu stwiel*, cp. It. 'lungo come uno stollo'. Mistaken by Barb. for إِسْتِعْلَاء from إِسْتَعْلَى , to rise higher.

T

Ta' prep. Of, shortened from of بتاع or متاع , but in the phrase *ja t'Alla*, an oath, it corresponds to Ar. ت used in swearing; cp. تَاللّٰه , by God, I swear by God, Hava.

Ta' Bilħaqq, adv. Indeed. Described as 'bad, vulgar Arabic' مْتَاع بِالحَقّ by Barb., this is one of the many loan-formations from Italian *davvero* (= *da* + *vero*). For the M. translation of Italian *da*, from, as, cp. *wieġeb ta' raġel* for *rispose da galantuomo*.

Talaw, 'You there, come here' (Gozo), sounds like a composite formation made up of *ta'*, (of) + *'l haw* (here). Etymologically it is made up of Ar. Imperative تَعَالَ , come on (Hava) [form VI of عَلِيَ or عَلَا] + M. *haw*, shortened form of *hawn*, here. The M. word would thus be the equivalent of the colloquial Ar. phrase تَعَالَ هُنَا , come here. M. *tala haw* > *talaw*. Strictly speaking, orthographically it should be written *tagħâl haw*.

Ta' Linqas, adv. At least; a loan translation from It. *di meno*, however, nevertheless.

Taparsi, adv. Fictitiously, feigningly. Barb. gives Sic. *'ntuppari o ntupparsi*, nascondersi la faccia con un velo e quindi il senso siciliano: agire simultaamente o copertemente; quindi il maltese non è un avverbio, ma ben un verbo, che ha perduto il suo significato originale'. But the M. form agrees with Sic. *mparissi*, also an adverb 'con finzione'. Giac. de Greg. S G I vol. 7.

Tapsina, f.n. Bed-pan, Fal. Not in Desс. Barb. suggests Sic. *tapizzina*, diminutive of *tappu* (whence M. *tapp*), stopper, plug. But for a meaning nearer to the Maltese, cp. Ar. طَبْسي or تُبْسي, pl. تَبَاسِي, 'plateau, plat, soucoups', Beauss.; 'assiette', Dozy. Final *na* in *tapsina* is a Romance diminutive suffix.

Taptap, tr. v. To pat, to stroke. Linked up with دَبْدَبَة from دَبْدَبَ, to resound (trampling), by Dess. For closer M. meaning, cp. طَبْطَبَ, to pat, to stroke, Elias. Barb. besides دَبْدَبَ suggests Sic. *taptappiari*, a similar onomatopoeic formation.

Taqtaq, int. v. To talk too much, to beat with anxiety (heart). *Dejjem (ilsienu) itaqtaq*, 'he is always talking too much'. Cp. Ar. طَقّ (dialect of Syria) to burst, to crack, and طَقْطَقَ, to resound, Hava. Cp. also تَقْتَعَ, to cause to stammer (confusion), Hava. For the correspondence of Ar. ع to M. *q*, cp. M. *wisq*, much, and Ar. وَسْع, extent.

Temm, tr. v. To finish, to bring to an end; Ar. تَمَّ, to be complete, تَمَّ ب, to achieve. The purely local VIIth form *intemm* in *intemm bilgħali* is an It. calque. Cp. *sfinito di dolore*.

Teptep, tr. v. To wink (eyes). Barb. links it up with دَبْدَبَ and Dess. suggests طَفْطَفَ, to splutter (candle). The M. verb is seemingly a variant of *taptap* (q.v.) and this sense is a translation of It. *battere*, to strike. Cp. the expression *in un batter d'occhio*, 'in the twinkling of an eye'; M. *f'teptipa (ħakka) ta' għajn*. A common variant of *teptep* is *petpet (għajnejh)*, to blink.

Textex, int. v. To fizzle (oil, etc.). A current word though not recorded in the M. dictionaries. Cp. طَشّ, to produce a bubbling (hot iron steeped into water), Hava; تَشْتَشَ, 'pétiller (tabac, feu, méche, chose jetée dans la friture; crépiter (feu, flamme)'; تَشْتِيش (M. *textix*), 'pétillement, crépitation,' Beauss.

Thir, v.n. Piles (in the anus). For the M. meaning, cp. طَحِير, 'coliques, contorsions dans le ventre qui rendent la respiration difficile', Kaz.

Tirma, f.n. Backside. Though this is still heard in Birgu and elsewhere, it is not in the M. dictionaries. It occurs in N. Af. Ar. Cp. '*terma*, pl. *tram* et *trem*, cul'. 'Le mot ترمة avec le sens de "cul" ou avec le sens de "fesse" ou avec les deux sens à la fois apparaît dans tout le Maghreb', Març. p. 244.

Toffieħ, m.n. With *toffieħ t'Adam*, tomatoes, cp. تفّاحة ابونا ادم, 'éminence audevant de la gorge', Dozy; seemingly a translation of It. *pomo d'Adamo*, English *Adam's apple*. If the M. phrase is likewise a translation, it may well be that the idea was first suggested by the popular comparison of a man's prominent larynx to the forbidden apple eaten by Adam or the possible popular conception that Adam was unable to swallow the forbidden fruit and the *toffieħa* stuck in his throat! But M. *t'Adam* may also be Ar. إدام, condiment. With M. *belludja* in *toffieħ ta' belludja* cp. Berb. *ebellud*, 'glands' (acorn) given by Destaing. But Belludia is also the name of a fertile area in South Sicily, between Noto and Ragusa.

Troffa, f.n. A lock (of hair); tuft (of glass); a small quantity of. Dess. thinks that if the word is Semitic, it links up with أُطْرُوفَة, a novelty, or there might be a link between the idea of hair and the tamarisk طُرْفَاء with its hair-like leaves'. Barb. gives طَرْفَة, with a completely different meaning. N. Afr. Ar. has طريف, 'un petit morceau, un peu, un brin', Beauss. But the M. word is Sic. *troffa* 'mucchio d'erba o di virgulti. *Troffa* per vituperio si dice ad uomo da nulla', Mort., (with which cp. M. *fih troffa*). Cp. also Fr. *touffe*, whence English *tuft*.

W

Werwer, tr. v. To terrify. Barb. gives وَرْوَرَ, to look fixedly at, whence: to speak excitedly. Dess. simply refers to وَرْوَرَ, given also by Stumme In Beauss. وَرْوَرَ means something different. For a closer origin, cp. وَلْوَلَ, to wail, to shriek. The M. verb may also be from وَرَأَ, to repel, reduced to a repeated biconsonantal base in Maltese, whence *werwer*

for *war* + *war*. With M. *x'int twerwer u tgħid?* 'What are you chattering about?', cp. Ar. وَرْوَرَ في الكَلَام, he spoke volubly, Hava.

Werżaq, int. v. To scream. The M. quadriliteral seems to be a local onomatopoeic formation. It is possible that the M. verb may have resulted from a combination of the first base of quadriliteral *werwer* (q.v.) and obsolete *żagħaq* Ar. زَعَقَ, to shriek, whence *werżaq* (for *wer* + *zagħaq*) to scream with fear, to shriek, whence *werżieq*, grasshopper, (we say *il-werżieq iwerżaq*), which Dess links up with Ar. أَرْسَح, with long, skinny legs (but usually of the wolf).

Widen, m.n. Hearing. Occurring only in the idiom *ta widen*, 'he gave ear to', which is a translation of It. *prestar orecchio*. The M. word for *ear* (Ar. أُذُن, whence M. *widen*), is *widna*, noun of unity, with *widnejn* as its pl., originally dual of obsolete *widen*, ear, and not *widintejn*, from *widna*, the singular used. *Widintejn* would be understood only in a strictly dual sense. For a similar use, cp. the following note given by Març., p. 219: 'il a été retiré de l'ancien duel un nom d'unité *udnina* qui est de beaucoup le mot le plus employé dans le sens de "une oreille" et même il existe un pluriel *udninat* de *udnina*'.

Wixx, m.n. Prosperity, Fal.; abundance, Car. The word occurs in the following idioms given by the latter: *ma fihx wixx*, 'he is not much good; there is nothing attractive in him'. *Xogħol bla wixx*, 'badly paid work.' According to Dess. M. *wixx* is Ar. وِسْع, wealth, probably the same as M. *wisq*, much; and Barb. gives عِيش, life, living, breed, Hava. But cp. وَشْي, gold-ore, and وَشَا, wealth, Hava.

X

Xahar, m.n. Ar. شَهْر, whence *mxabra*, menstruous (woman), with which cp. the meaning of the corresponding form in Barth.: 'qui a atteint la neuvieme mois de sa grossesse, qui doit accoucher dans le mois'.

Xahx, m.n. Fragments of stone. Barb. gives Ar. شِحْفَة, chip, slice, (شِقْفَة, fragments, in N. Afr.); but the M. word, as pointed out by Dess., occurs also in Freytag, شَحْش, 'fragmenta lapidum'.

Xandar, tr. v. To divulge; to publish (news); to broadcast. Barb. gives شَذَّر, to divulge, with ز for *n*. This suggestion is certainly interesting, but Ar. dictionaries record the fifth form تَشَذَّر, to be scattered, Hava, and not شَذَّر. According to Dess., possibly cp. شَنْطَرَ, to affront, شَنْتَرَ, to speak ill of; *xandari*, divulger, broadcaster, is possibly جَانْدَار, (Dozy), supposing this official to have been charged with making proclamations. The acceptable explanation is that given by Barb., but M. *n* must be accounted for as an additional second radical changing a triliteral verb to a quadriliteral. For a similar example, cp. *hendem*, to demolish, from هَدَمَ, to pull down (a building, etc.), Hava. Cp. also שִׁדֵּר, to send, revived from Aramaic in modern Hebrew, to express 'to broadcast' in the same way as the Maltese speak of *ix-xandir ta' l-aħbarijiet*, 'the broadcasting of news', and Talmudic שִׁדֵּר, to send.

Xagħwiet in *mar xagħwiet*, also *xaħwiet* or *xawiet* (Car.), to form a wrong opinion; to misjudge. This word which is not given by Fal. is unexplained by Barb. and Dess. Cp. possibly شَاعٍ and pl. شَوَاعٍ, removed, scattered, Hava, 'éloigné, situé à une grande distance', Kaz. In this sense, M. *xagħwiet* might be pl. of obsolete *xagħwa*, Ar. شَاعِيَة, the phrase *mar xagħwiet* semantically corresponding to *mar 'il bogħod* (*b'moħħu, ħsiebu*, etc.), literally 'he went far (from the truth)' etc. but *iet* in *xagħwiet* might more likely also be an adverbial suffix as in *waranijiet*, backwards; *taħtnijiet*, downwards. If this is correct, we should write *xagħwiet* and not *xaħwiet* or *xawiet*, as no such meaning can be traced under شهو √XHW or شوى √XW(J).

Xatar used in the 2nd and 5th form only in the sense of 'to divide unequally, to render disproportionate', whence *imxattra* said of a goat or a sheep, etc. which has its udders unequal. For Maltese meaning cp. شَطَرَ, '(1) partager en deux parties égales; (2) traire une femelle de deux trayons seulement en laissant les deux autres intacts; (3) tirer à la femelle la moitié seulement du lait qu'elle peut donner à la fois; (4) avoir un pis plus long que l'autre (se dit des brebis)', Kaz. With *xtur*, pl. of obsolete *xatar*, occurring in the current idiom *ħadd ma jara xturu*, 'no one notices his own defects', cp. Ar. شَتَر, defect, slit, from شَتَرَ, to cut, to slit, Hava.

Xeblek, tr. v. To intertwine; a quadriliteral from Ar. شَبَكَ , to entangle, knit together (Hava). For a similar quadriliteral also from شَبَكَ cp. شَرْبَكَ , to entangle, to confuse, given by Hava as a Syrian word under شَرَبَ , though we should expect it under شَبَكَ . Cp. also Dozy. Barb. thinks ر stands for ب of the 2nd form شَبَّكَ , but the correst explanation is not that we have an interchange of consonants but that ر as a second additional radical turning a triliteral verb into a quadriliteral serves to stress the intensity, or frequency, of the action thereof as expressed by the 1st from and, comparatively, even by the 2nd form.

Xela, tr. v. To accuse, considered a variant of *xena* (q.v.) by Dess., might link up with شَالَى , 'defier, (se dit d'un cavalier qui sort des rangs et appelle au combat un cavalier ennemi)', Beauss. Barb.'s explanation that *xela* stands for شَكَا الى , to complain, is phonetically inadmissible.

Xellef, tr. v. To chip, to splinter. According to Barb., it stands for Syrian شَلْحَفَ , to cut to pieces, with 3rd radical eliminated. Dess. gives شَلَّفَ on the authority of Tunisian natives 'seemingly a variant of ثَلَمَ ', to notch (a blade), Hava. But cp. شَلَّفَ , 'frapper au hasard', Dozy, and *šálaf* 'jeter sans y prendre garde', with 2nd form conveying a frequentative meaning of 1st Form, Barth. In this sense the meaning of *xellef* in Maltese has been restricted to the effect of the action, expressed by its Arabic correspondence.

Xemnaq, tr. v. To despise. Not in Dess. Barb.'s extraordinary explanation is that it derives from Eng. *shame*. *Xemnaq* is seemingly a variant of obsolete *xena* (q.v.) whence M. *xniegħa*, false rumour, with *m* as an additional 2nd radical turning an originally triliteral verb into a quadriliteral with final *q* standing for original ع , with which cp. *ċaqlaq* to move, Ar. شَعْلَعَ , to suspend, to hang, (Spiro Bey), and M. *wisq*, much, Ar. وِسْع .

Xena, tr. v. To accuse, Fal.; to hate, to be ill disposed towards, Car. It. does not link up with شَنَعَ , to revile, as explained by Dess. but is obviously Ar. شَنِئَ or شَنَأَ , to hate, to loathe, because if it is linked up with شَنَعَ , (1) grammatically we should expect pp. *mixnugħ* not *mixni*, (2) formally, the vocalic sequence would be *a-a* (cp. *bala'*, to

swallow), or o-o (cp. *forogħ*, to ebb) generally with a passive sense, (3) semantically, in the sense given by Car., *xena* is nearer to شَنَأَ .

Xendi, m. adj. Dwarfish. According to Barb. this word is an adaptation of It. *scendi*, 2nd pers. sing. of *scendere*, to descend. Dess. gives شِنْتِي , 'a word used by the S. Tunisian Bedouins'. But for a possible connection with the M. meaning, cp. Ar. شَنِثَ , 'être gros, épais (se dit de la main ou des babines du chameau)', Kaz., 'Crassus fuit de manu, de cameli labio', Frey. The Maltese meaning of 'dwarfishness' seems to be suggested by that of physical stoutness and shortness conveyed by the Arabic verb and characteristic of 'dwarfs'.

Xengel, tr. v. To rock (a cradle); move about; to shake (one' head); *ixxengel* (2nd form), to stagger (drunkard etc.). Barb. mistook it for Sic. *cianchillari* or *scianchilari* etc., but according to Dess. it is 'seemingly a West-Asiatic word, cp. شَنْكَل , elephant's trunk; جَنْكَل , to trip, with Arabic derivative شُنْكُل , a window-catch'. With M. *xengel*, cp. Ar. شَنْكَلَ , to hook, and in Egypt, to trip up, denominative verb from شَنْكَل , hook, Hava, whence possibly the original Maltese meaning 'to move something attached to a hook'. Beauss. gives شَنْقَل , 'accrocher'.

Xerfija, f.n. A black gown, Fal.; a kind of gown formerly worn by Maltese women, Car. In an interesting note Dess. writes: "*xerfija*, [presumably "the noble"]; only the pl. شُرَافِي is found in Freytag. There is also a head-covering called شَرْبِيَّة , pl. شَرَابِي , possibly a corruption of جَرْبِيَّة , (i.e. from the island of Jerba, Dozy). Did the *xerfija* get its name from having been brought back from the Meccan pilgrimage? The stuff of which the *faldetta* is made is still called *tan-nobiltà*". Personally, as most names of M. vestments are either Romance or loan-translations, I think *xerfija* is very likely a translation of *tan-nobiltà* or vice versa, to describe the gown that originally may have been worn by women belonging to the better classes as a mark of شُرْفَة , honour. Kaz. gives شُرَافِيّ , 'étoffes blanches, vêtements blancs'. In Maltese, *xerfija*, like *bidwija*, a woman peasant, and *ġeblija*, stony, is a fem. adjectival pattern.

Xettel, tr. v. To transplant; denominative verb from *xitla*, plant with which cp. N. Afr. and Syrian شَتْلَة , nursery plant, whence *mixtla*, seed-

plot, مَشْتَلَة , same meaning. Egyptian has شَتَلَ , to transplant (a plant), Hava. But the 2nd form occurs also in N. Afr. Ar. Cp. شتّل , 'faire monter une plante en graine pour conserver la graine', Beauss. The Arabic word looks like a loan from Hebrew or Syriac. Cp. Heb. שָׁתַל , to transplant, same meaning in Neo-Hebrew; Aramaic שְׁתַל ; Syriac ܫܬܠ ; Assyrian *šitlu*.

ż

Żafżaf, int. v. To chirp (birds), Car.; Not in Fal.; unexplained by Dess. and by Barb. Cp. زَفْزَف , 'siffler, vent, balle, etc.' whence زَفْزَافِي 'vent froid', Beauss., a quadriliteral by repetition of a biradical base زَفّ , to blow gently, Hava, whence M. *żiffa*, breeze, gentle cool wind with which contrast N. Afr. Ar. زفّ , 'souffler par rafales, vent,' and زَفَّة 'coup de vent violent, rafale,' Beauss. For a similar contrast of meaning, see *xerfija* and *jies*.

Żagħżugħ, adj. and m.n. Youthful, a young man. Arabic has زُغْلُول , nimble; child, baby, and زَغْزَغ , lively, sprightly, Hava. Dess. gives زُغْزُغ , small, 'petit de taille (homme)', Kaz. Cp. also زعزوع , 'flandrin, fluet et élancé', Dozy.

Żaqżaq, int. v. To creak (new shoes, etc.). For M. meaning, cp. زَقْزَق , 'crier, faire du bruit, souliers neufs, plume à écrire, porte; gémir, navire secoué par la vague, plafond', Beauss. Syr. Ar. زَقْزَقَ , to crackle, Hava. By metathesis of the two radicals of the repeated biconsonantal base, we have another onomatopoeic verb *qażqaż*, to grunt (q.v.). *Zekzek*, to hiss, suggested by Dess., corresponds to Sic. *zicchi-zicchi*, 'il verso che fa la cicala', Giac. de Greg. SGI vol. 7.

Żatat, invariable adj. (also *żattât*, with the stress on the second syllable). Presumptuous, unduly confident. Not in Dess. I cannot see how it can link up with صَتَّ , to shout, to yell, (Hava), as suggested by Barb. I suggest instead that M. *żatat* may link up more convincingly

with زطّاط, which is Moroccan for 'a guide', Beauss. – a cicerone whose proverbial ostentation of knowledge may have suggested the M. meaning. Cp. also تزتّت (M. *iżżattat*, to show off, to be presumptuous), to be adorned (bride), Hava, and زتّت, 'se précipiter droit devant soi', مزتّت 'qui se précipite droit sur, avec précipitation', Beauss.

Żegleg, tr. v. To wriggle. Not in Dess. Besides زَفْزَق, to dandle (a child), given by Barb., which would give *żaqżaq* or *żegżeg*, cp. also Ar. زَحْلَق, to slide, and تزحلق, to glide, Hava. For the exact M. meaning, cp. N. Afr. زحلق, 'faire glisser', تزحلق (M. *iżżegleg*), 'glisser sur le cul', مزحلق, (M. *imżegleg*), 'en pente et très glissant, terrain,' Beauss. Note unusual correspondence of Ar. ح to *g* in M. A variant of M. *żegleg* is *żengel* – *iżżengel* (2nd form) – which is not in the M. dictionaries.

Żeġġ, int. v. To move quickly (fish, bird, etc.); to shine (eyes), whence *żeġġeġ għajnejh*, 'his eyes shone with excitement' (literally, he made his eyes shine with excitement). Cp. زَجّ, to run (ostrich), to shoot arrows; زجّج, to arch (the eyebrows), Hava, 'briller comme le verre', Beauss., (whence M. dictionary word *żġieġ*, glass which in spoken Maltese is *ħġieġ*).

Żernaq, int. v. To dawn. Barb. derives it from Sic. *zurnicari*, to become blue; not in Mort. Desss. derives it from زَرْنَق (perfect beauty, Frey.), زَرْنَقَة in Hava. I explain the M. word as a quadriliteral verb by insertion of *n* as an additional third radical in زَرِقَ, إزْرَقَّ, to be blue, whence زَرْقَا, the sky (cp. the use of *blue* for sky in 'a bolt from the blue'). For the insertion of *n* as an additional radical, cp. *xeblek* from √X.B.K. (q.v.) and *xandar* from √X.D.R.

Żerżaq, tr. v. To make something glide down; *iżżerżaq* (2nd form) to slip down. Barb. seems to derive it from زَرْنَق, (Dozy), which has a different meaning altogether. Dess. more convincingly explains it as an intensive form of *żellaq*, to make something glide down, to render slippery, to trip up (Ar. زَلَّق). I suggest for comparison تزرّق, (M. *iżżerżaq*) which is Moroccan for 'se glisser, s'introduire secretement, passer par un lieu sans être vu', Beauss., with which cp. M. *żerżaqtlu xi ħaġa tal-flus*, 'I gave him some money secretly; I slipped some money into his hands.'

Żorr, m. adj. Rude, rough, ill-behaved. According to Barb. this adj. is from Syrian ܙܪ , biting or knotty, and according to Dess. from زُور , falsehood. The M. adj. derives from Sic. *zurru* 'contrario di morbido e di liscio, ruvido' which might, perhaps, link up with Ar. زَرَّ , to ill-treat, Hava, and زِرَّة , 'rigueur, violence, Beauss.